

Meaningfy

Employee Handbook

January 2026

2nd Edition

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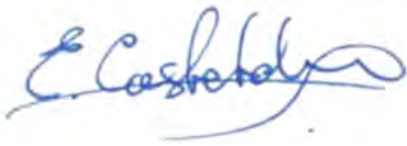
Employee Handbook - Second Edition (2026)

☀ Hello Everyone!

We're excited to share with you the second edition of our employee handbook. Whether you're just joining us or have been part of the team for years, this handbook is here to support you in your journey with our company.

This updated edition reflects how we've continued to grow and evolve over the past year. Inside, you'll find clear guidance on our policies, culture, and expectations—resources designed to help you work confidently, stay informed, and feel connected.

Our goal is to make your experience positive, productive, and fulfilling. If you have any questions or need clarification, please reach out to your manager at any time. We're here to help you thrive.



Eugen Costetchi

Post scriptum:

Rarely something truly novel is invented under the sun. We pragmatically accept this premise and seek to adopt and adapt best practices of other organisations that resonate with us.

Meaningful practices described in this handbook were strongly inspired by:

- 37 signals Handbook,
- Valve's Handbook,
- Shaping Up methodology,
- and SCRUM methodology.

References

- Values chart <https://mail.google.com/mail/u/0/#inbox/FMfcgzGxSbrtBwqPxLhHKNbTkgdwLFFB>
- How to write: <https://blissbook.com/>
- <https://www.caseiq.com/resources/12-amazing-employee-handbook-examples/>
 - <https://basecamp.com/handbook>
 - Valve handbook https://steamcdn-a.akamaihd.net/apps/valve/Valve_NewEmployeeHandbook.pdf
 - MotleysFool <https://insidemotleyfool.wordpress.com/wp-content/uploads/2012/04/fool-rules-2012.pdf>
 - <https://www.scribd.com/doc/293508174/Dollar-General-Employee-Handbook>
 - <https://books.airmason.com/examples/sterling>
 - <https://www.fastcompany.com/3039860/behold-someone-made-an-employee-manual-youll-actually-want-to-read>
 - HubSpot <https://www.slideshare.net/HubSpot/the-hubspot-culture-code-creating-a-company-we-love#16>
 - Disquis <https://www.dropbox.com/s/u6suqbbk2w1vbwz/Disqus%20Culture%20Book.pdf>
 - <https://www.prontomarketing.com/employee-handbook/>
 - Trello <https://trello.com/b/HbTEX5hb/employee-manual>

- Netflix <https://www.slideshare.net/reed2001/culture-2009>
- <https://www.trinet.com/insights/employee-handbook-examples>
- Amazon handbook https://core-docs.s3.amazonaws.com/documents/asset/uploaded_file/1039/RSU_57/2338358/Hourly_employee_handbook_2022-23.pdf

What's New in the Employee Handbook (2026)

Welcome to **What's New in the Employee Handbook (EHB) 2026**. This page highlights every significant addition, new principle or section, and rule introduced in the EHB 2026 edition. Its purpose is to allow you to quickly familiarise yourself with the latest updates, whether brand-new pages, revised procedures or fresh policies, without having to reread the entire handbook.

Edition	Year
First edition	2025
Second edition	2026

Section / Page	Change / Update / Added	Content
Code of Conduct	Added	Use professional language: Refrain from foul language, negative criticism and gossiping to maintain respect and a positive work environment.
Strategic Plan	Updated	Strategic Principles No Investors: Meaningfy remains self-funded, prioritizing autonomy and long-term sustainability. Camel Company Vision: The company thrives in both growth and downturn cycles by diversifying revenue and aligning operations with pragmatic goals. This concept draws on the 'Camel Company' model, which describes self-funded organisations that withstand market fluctuations without external investment. Open Source and Impact: Open-source tools and solutions ensure Meaningfy leads with transparency, creating value beyond profit.
Data Privacy and Information Security Policy	Update and added	Information Security: How We Protect Data Here's what we do to keep Meaningfy's data secure: Data classification: We categorise all data by sensitivity level (Employee Information, Client Information, Financial Data, Internal Communications, Security Credentials, Research Outputs, Partnership Agreements).

1. **Access Control:**

- Use tools such as multifactor authentication (MFA) and, where available, VPNs for both remote work and internal network access. Only grant access on a need-to-know basis and revoke it when no longer necessary (e.g., regularly audit Google Drive folders, GitHub repos, Jira projects and SSH accounts).

Approved Tools: Store and share data **only via company-approved platforms** (e.g., Google Workspace, Slack, Confluence,

- Jira, Airtable).

The up-to-date list is maintained by People Operations and can be found in the *Work Environment* section → **General-purpose tools**.

2. **System Security:**

- Use firewalls, anti-malware, and regular updates to protect our systems. Continuously monitor for vulnerabilities and conduct annual
- OWASP (Open Web Application Security Project)-style penetration tests on applications and APIs.

3. **Data Protection:**

- Encrypt data at rest and during transfers.
- Separate production from testing environments, and ensure backups are available.

4. **Third-Party Oversight:**

- Assess third-party services for risks.
- Require subcontractors handling Meaningfy data to follow these same standards.

5. **Physical Security:**

- Restrict data access to secure, approved environments.

6. **Incident Response:**

- Report breaches or potential issues within 72 hours to your line manager or via the Slack, .
- Act swiftly to minimize risks and prevent future incidents.

What's Expected of You

As part of the Meaningfy team, here's what you need to do:

		1. Compliance: - Follow the principles and standards laid out in this policy. Complete annual security awareness training. (programme under development by People Operations; details will be announced in dedicated Slack channel) 2. Be Organized: - Keep track of open-source software (OSS), access logs, and any tools you use. - Document any security measures you implement. 3. Ethical Data Handling: - Only use Meaningfy or client data for its intended purpose. Inform Meaningfy of any significant contributions you make to OSS to ensure compliance. 4. Report Breaches Immediately: If you notice a potential or actual data breach, report it within 72 hours by Slack DM or email to your line manager, the Project Shipper, the Head of Operations, or the CEO. Use whichever channel is fastest; the first recipient will escalate according to the incident-response playbook.
Project anatomy	Updated	Our work is organised into projects. Each project begins with a charter, is shaped before execution into deliverables, and is shipped to stakeholders (internal or external). Before execution begins, work is shaped so that builders can proceed effectively. Shipping starts once deliverables are ready. After deliverables are shipped and accepted by stakeholders, the project is closed. Customer success management and communication are continuous activities, beginning at project inception and extending beyond project closure.

Managing Out-of-Contract Improvements	New page	Here is our approach for managing tasks related to improving, maintaining, and extending project tools that were not specifically requested by the client and, therefore, are not included in the contract scope. Creating a Dedicated EPIC – “Improvements Outside Contract” 1. The “Improvements Outside Contract” EPIC is not a general rule but a case-by-case approach. Each instance must be discussed individually for each project, and if approved by Eugen and Thomas, we can create such an EPIC. 2. The EPIC should be created within the project, not in Meaningfy 2025 (PM25), to maintain clarity and accountability at the team level. 3. Every EPIC must be well-defined and have a clear appetite (time budget allocated). A proper EPIC PITCH should be prepared according to our internal guidelines to avoid accumulating unplanned activities that might impact project deliveries. 4. Activities included in the EPIC must be validated at the conceptual level by Eugen and Thomas to ensure efficient and appropriate resource allocation. 5. We must ensure that these activities cannot initially be integrated into one of the existing WPs under the current contract. Key Considerations: 1. Small improvement tasks can be absorbed by project budgets and included in the relevant EPICs or Stories that correlate with an active WP in the contract. 2. If an improvement task cannot be absorbed into an active EPIC/WP, it means the scope is too large, or the idea is too ambitious, and should be handled through a dedicated new EPIC – “Improvements Outside Contract”. 3. For this EPIC, we apply the same rules and approach as for all other EPICs, ensuring an EPIC PITCH is created according to our internal standard. 4. All stories, including continuous improvement efforts, must have a defined appetite to ensure they do not delay active project deliveries and can be managed within the given timeframe. This approach aligns with Shape Up and Agile Scrum principles, ensuring flexibility, clarity, and efficiency in managing out-of-scope improvements. Let me know if you need any clarifications. If needed, we can discuss this topic with Eugen and Thomas at the appropriate time. However, the general approach for handling such situations is outlined above.
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Redelivery Policy

New page

Purpose:

Establish a clear, repeatable process for re-delivery work driven by client or operational feedback, without compromising the traceability or stability of the original Epics.

1. Definitions

- **Initial Epic:** The package of functionality approved at the start of a build cycle, with a fixed appetite (allocated time & resources).
- **Done:** Status applied once an Epic's deliverables have been shipped.
- **Redelivery:** Any rework required when the initial deliverable is not accepted or needs adjustments beyond the original appetite.

2. Procedure**2.1 Closing the Initial Epic**

- At the end of the first delivery, mark the Epic **Done** and close it—regardless of final acceptance.

2.2 Triggering Redelivery

- If feedback or change requests exceed the scope and appetite of the closed Epic, initiate a redelivery.

2.3 Creating a New Epic

- Open a dedicated Epic for redelivery only, with a new appetite and pitch.
- **Minimum fields:**
 - **Title:** "[Component] Redelivery – D??.?"
 - **Summary:** "Rework as per client/operational feedback"

2.4 Logging Activities

- Create **all** sub-tasks and stories **exclusively** in the new Epic.
- **Do not** open new tickets or log additional hours against the closed (Done) Epics.

2.5 Traceability

- In the new Epic's comments, reference the original Epic and state the reason for redelivery.

3. Time-Logging Rules

- Any unlogged hours **prior** to an Epic being marked Done may be entered retrospectively against that Epic.
- **All** hours relating to redelivery work **must** be logged only in the newly created Epic, from the moment it is opened.

4. Post-Redelivery Review

		• Lessons Learned (default) ○ Within 5 working days of finishing a redelivery, the team captures: ■ what worked ■ what didn't ■ immediate improvement actions ○ Format: concise bullet list, linked to the redelivery Epic. • Post-Mortem (when required) ○ If the redelivery exceeds the new appetite or uncovers critical issues, run a formal root-cause analysis. ○ Output: structured report (timeline, findings, contributing factors, actions), attached to the Epic and archived on the intranet. • Responsibilities ○ Shipper / Shaper: schedules and facilitates the review / post-mortem. ○ Delivery Crew: provides data and insights. ○ Operational Manager: stores the documentation, broadcasts key takeaways, and updates any affected processes. 5. Responsibilities • Shipper/ Shaper : Approves closure of initial Epics and triggers creation of the redelivery Epic. • Shipper/ Shaper: Creates sub-tasks/stories and logs all redelivery activities according to this policy. • Operational Manager: Monitors compliance with this policy compliance and maintains the intranet/reporting platform.
Communication channels	Deleted,	Deleted, https://meaningfy.atlassian.net/wiki/x/CIApew content has been integrated into the "Work environment" page

Role structure	Updated and added	On Roles, Profiles and Levels At Meaningfy we distinguish between Roles and Profiles. Each Profile can have five levels described in the section on making a career. Profiles are defined in terms of skills, competencies and academic background that a person has. We hire the following profiles: • Semantic Engineer • Software Engineer • DevOps Engineer • QA Engineer Roles are defined in terms of responsibilities in the company or a project. Most often we refer to project roles (real-world equivalents in parentheses): • Mastermind Wizard (Business Developer) • Shaper (Project Owner) • Builder (Engineering or Implementation Lead) • Shipper (Delivery Manager) • Quality Overseer (QA Lead) • Customer Success Manager (Client Relationship Manager) The company roles are: • CEO • Operations Officer • Finance Officer • Communications and Marketing Officer • Business Development and Sales Officer
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Documentation Standards	Updated	Naming Conventions To ensure consistency and easy tracking, use this naming convention for all files and documents: {Date} {Client-Order-Number} {Jira-key} {Document-Type} {Title} • Date: Use ISO format YYYY-MM-DD. • Client-Order-Number: A client-unique identifier for the project (e.g., 76129). • Jira-key: The JIRA project key/identifier (e.g., EPO18). • Document-Type: Abbreviated document type (e.g., MM for Meeting Minutes, PPT for PowerPoint). • Title: Brief description of the document's content. Example: 2025-11-24 [EPO18] 76129 MM Monthly Meeting Header and Footer All released documents shall include a header and a footer. The header shall contain the document title, release date, and release version. The footer shall contain the page number and the total number of pages. For layout or stylistic reasons, the required information may be placed interchangeably in the header or footer, provided that all required information is present and clearly visible on each page. Any released document shall be provided in PDF format. If the native (editable) format is also required, it shall be shared together with the corresponding PDF version.
Onboarding	Added	Recorded Screencasts: When available, you'll receive pre-recorded walkthroughs of key onboarding topics; while not all sessions may yet be recorded, we're continually expanding our library so that you—and future hires—can ramp up without always needing live calls.
Work environment	Update	The entire page has been updated 1. Operating system & platform preferences At Meaningfy we standardise on Linux because our CI pipelines, container images and internal scripts target that environment. We recommend a recent LTS release (Ubuntu 22.04 LTS, Linux Mint 21 LTS) or a well-supported rolling distro (EndeavourOS, Fedora Silverblue).

- **Install Linux from day one** (native, dual-boot, or a VM/WSL2 image).
If you must start on Windows + WSL or macOS, that is acceptable
- **provided you resolve platform-specific issues independently.**
- Should the same OS-related problem block delivery more than once, you may be asked to migrate fully to Linux in your own time.

Why so strict?

Mixed OS setups create hidden discrepancies (different CLI tools, case-sensitive paths, Docker quirks). A common platform keeps “works on my machine” incidents—and support overhead—near zero.

2. Intranet – the single source of truth

<http://intranet.meaningfy.ws>

Our intranet aggregates everything that matters:

- **Vacation requests** – submit, track approval, see team availability.
- **Timesheets** – export for invoicing.
- **Project dashboards** – shippers update budget burn-down, milestone status and risks; everyone sees the same data.

All entries are synchronised from—and to—Airtable, so numbers stay consistent across tools.

3. General-purpose tools (Google Workspace)

Email – Your @meaningfy address is your digital ID; use it only for external stakeholders (clients / vendors). Internal conversations stay on Slack.

Drive – Store contracts, decks, spreadsheets. Project folders follow the convention: <client>_<project>_<yyyy> and are curated by the Team Shaper.

Calendar – Events originate in Airtable, propagate automatically to Google Calendar. Use Calendar only to invite attendees; do not store private notes there.

4. Communication & Collaboration

Slack is our real-time backbone.

- Project channels: one per project (e.g. #proj-client-xyz).
- #general: company-wide announcements, daily stand-ups and town-halls.
- #aligning: people/management topics and onsite events.
- #learning: training links and technical papers.
- #random: social chat, memes, weekend photos.
- Technical feeds: #dev-info, #task-info, #swarmia-kpi.

Etiquette

Reply in threads, use @channel sparingly (major releases or blockers), use @here only for production emergencies, and schedule meetings if a huddle will exceed fifteen minutes.

Confluence – project & knowledge wiki

Each project or programme has its own Space with four core pages:

1. *Impact filter* (purpose and success criteria)
2. *Meeting minutes*
3. *Requirements* (business needs and work shapes)
4. *Technical documentation* (diagrams, decisions, hand-over notes).

The Team Shaper keeps structure tidy; everyone contributes. Company-wide Spaces include *Meaningfy*, *Communication* and *Business Development*. production emergencies).

5. Project & knowledge management

Jira – canonical backlog and sprint board. Log time, move tickets, and present progress via **Hill Charts**.

<https://meaningfy.atlassian.net/jira/projects>

Confluence – every project has a space for pitches, requirements, meeting minutes and technical decisions.

<https://meaningfy.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces>

SmartSheet – client-facing Gantt charts that mirror Jira epics and contractual milestones.

6. Monitoring & operations – Airtable

<https://airtable.com/appC1oe54...>

- **KPIs** – individual velocity, project margin, client NPS.
- **Vacations & timesheets** – master record that feeds invoicing.
- **Forecast & finance** – quarterly pipeline, cash-flow, ARR.

7. Code & delivery infrastructure

GitHub – mono-repos and micro-repos; GitHub Actions run tests, build Docker images and push artefacts.

Zoho Invoice – generates PDF invoices from approved timesheets; recommended but not mandatory if you already use compliant software.

8. Role-specific toolkits

Software developers

- **PyCharm Professional** (licence provided) or any IDE that supports remote interpreters, Docker and Python linters.
- Adhere to black + ruff formatting; commit hooks shipped in each repo.

Semantic engineers

- **Enterprise Architect** + **model2owl** for UML-to-OWL pipelines.
- **VocBench** for vocabulary curation.
- Paid platforms (TopBraid EDG, PoolParty) can be adopted if ROI is justified – align with your manager first.

DevOps / SRE

- **Hetzner Cloud** for VMs, DNS and S3-compatible storage.
 - **GoDaddy / EuroDNS** for domain registration and delegation.
 - Terraform modules live in `infra/` within each repo; state stored in remote backend.
-

One OS, one intranet, one communication lane, and a curated toolchain keep our fully-remote team predictable, auditable and fast. Stick to the defaults—deviate only with a clear business reason.

Use of Company Email	Updated and added	Use of Company Email To maintain security, professionalism, and consistency, all employees must use their Meaningfy company email account for work-related activities and identification. Your company email is your official identifier within Meaningfy and for all external communications. Guidelines for Using Company Email: • Use your @meaningfy.com address for all external and internal work-related communications (clients, vendors, audits, Git operations, etc.). GitHub commits: set your official Meaningfy email in Git config (<code>git config --global user.email "firstname.lastname@meaningfy.com"</code>) so that contributions are properly attributed. If you maintain separate open-source projects and prefer not to expose your corporate email, you may add your @meaningfy.com address as a secondary GitHub email but commit with your personal address on those repos. • Systems access: your Meaningfy email is the only credential for company tools, platforms, and single sign-on flows. • Personal email: never use a personal address for any project-related accounts, tickets, or document sharing—except for the GitHub exception above.
Use of Company Email	Updated and added	Guidelines for Using Company Email: • Use your @meaningfy.com address for all external and internal work-related communications (clients, vendors, audits, Git operations, etc.). GitHub commits: set your official Meaningfy email in Git config (<code>git config --global user.email "firstname.lastname@meaningfy.com"</code>) so that contributions are properly attributed. If you maintain separate open-source projects and prefer not to expose your corporate email, you may add your @meaningfy.com address as a secondary GitHub email but commit with your personal address on those repos. • Systems access: your Meaningfy email is the only credential for company tools, platforms, and single sign-on flows. • Personal email: never use a personal address for any project-related accounts, tickets, or document sharing—except for the GitHub exception above.

Timesheet	Updated and added	You are required to complete your timesheet in Jira within five days after the end of each month. Accurate and timely timesheet entries are essential for Meaningfy to run operations smoothly and invoice clients correctly. We strongly encourage you to log your time at least weekly, rather than waiting until the end of the month. This keeps records up to date and helps address any issues early. Time off / vacation Time off (vacation) is logged in Jira to a dedicated issue for the current year (e.g., a specific Epic/issue created for vacations). The relevant issue will be communicated internally. When booking time off, please coordinate early with your manager and team to ensure coverage. Company holidays When the company is closed for designated company holidays, you should follow the same approach and log this time in Jira using the dedicated internal issue (as communicated internally). Invoice
Timesheet and Invoice	Updated	Invoice Submission 1. Log your hours in JIRA under every project and task you contributed to—this is the source of truth for your effort. 2. Export your activity report from the intranet's reporting module to verify and allocate your time accurately. 3. Prepare and send your invoice within seven days of month-end, attaching: • The exported activity report • Relevant receipts or documentation • A PDF invoice file 4. Submit by: Email: send all files to accounting@meaningfy.ws Email Body must contain and label the invoice number and total • invoice amount in Euro so it can be automatically processed by our database system. or • Intranet: upload via the dedicated invoice portal

Company Rituals: Staying Connected and Aligned	Added. A new section	Technical Knowledge Exchange What it is A monthly (or bi-monthly) slot where a volunteer colleague shares a short, content-focused talk on a technical topic (tools, techniques, lessons-learned). Why we do it • Surface expertise across teams • Encourage continuous learning • Strengthen our “one-team” culture in a fully remote setup How it works 1. Call for volunteers & topics: The Operational Manager (or rotating organizer) posts in #tech-exchange asking for speakers and topic proposals. 2. Vote on date & topic: A simple Slack poll selects the session date and topic. 3. Schedule & announce: The Operational Manager adds the session to the “Technical Knowledge Exchange” Company Confluence and Google calendar. 4. Deliver & discuss: Presenter runs a 20–30 min demo or slide deck, then Q&A in the same Slack thread. 5. Rotate: Each person is encouraged to present at least once per year. Tools & etiquette • Use Slack threads for coordination and follow-up questions • Keep the Confluence session calendar up to date • Archive slides or demos in our shared drive for future reference Ownership • Operational Manager: issues Slack calls, runs polls, updates the calendar • Presenter: prepares content, delivers the session, shares materials • Everyone: attends, provides feedback, and proposes new topics
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Why work at Meaningfy?

The unique advantages of being part of the Meaningfiers team

Here at Meaningfy, we aren't just offering jobs; we're presenting opportunities to make substantial impacts on major projects across the EU. This is your chance to shape your role and align it with what you're passionate about, contributing directly to our innovative projects and technological advancements.

Flexibility and Impact

Unlike larger, more rigid structures you might find in big corporations, our startup environment is highly adaptable, allowing for personal initiative and innovation. As a Meaningfier, you will enjoy the flexibility to tailor your role and responsibilities in ways that best utilise your skills and interests, ensuring that every day you are making a meaningful contribution.

Training and Mastery

We are committed to your professional growth, offering targeted training in Semantic Web technologies, alongside workshops, conferences, and certifications. These learning opportunities are facilitated by experts and are designed to keep you at the forefront of industry innovations, ensuring you maintain a competitive edge.

Visibility and Contribution

You'll work on projects that, while sometimes modest in scale, have a significant impact. Our commitment to open-source projects and enhancing semantic interoperability means your contributions will be recognised and valued at a European level, enhancing your professional visibility and sense of accomplishment.

Stability in a Startup

Despite our smaller size, we prioritise creating a stable and secure working environment. We seek long-term engagement, which means we're committed to business transparency and prudent practices, sharing regular updates on company health and future plans to ensure you feel secure and included in our growth journey.

Culture and Values

Our workplace culture is built on the S.M.I.L.E. principles—**S**ervice, **M**astery, **I**ntegrity, **L**eadership, and **E**xploration. This ethos ensures a supportive and ethical environment where innovation comes from collaboration. You'll work alongside colleagues who share knowledge freely and encourage the exploration of new ideas, fostering a culture of diversity, transparency, and collective growth.

Authentic Work-Life Balance

We understand that true productivity stems from a balance of professional achievements and personal well-being. We support this with flexible work arrangements, remote work options, and a supportive management style that encourages you to manage your professional and personal life effectively.

Collaborative Environment

Our work in enhancing semantic interoperability and developing enterprise knowledge graphs puts us at the cutting edge of technology. You'll collaborate with skilled colleagues and clients, pushing the boundaries of what's possible in data and knowledge management.

You are part of a dynamic team shaping the future of how organisations access and understand data. Here you are not just taking a job; you're stepping into a role that will grow with you, offering personal and professional development opportunities that are not easily found elsewhere. Together, we are on an exciting journey to revolutionise data management and drive significant impact across Europe. Thank you for your dedication and commitment to making Meaningfy a leader in our field.

Let's keep pushing boundaries because we don't just adapt to the future; we create it.

Vision and Culture

Vision

Meaningfy envisions a world where information and knowledge flow effortlessly between people and machines, empowering individuals and transforming societies.

Mission

We empower organisations to build knowledge-centric systems where information is clear, machines understand context, and people make better decisions based on shared meaning.

Tactical approaches to realise mission

Through our innovative solutions, we:

- Transform raw data into actionable insights, fuelling smarter decision-making;
- Bridge the gap between people and machines, fostering seamless knowledge exchange;
- Empower individuals and organizations with the tools to harness the full potential of their data;
- Cultivate a data-driven culture that unlocks creativity, innovation, and growth

Beliefs

We believe meaning and responsibility are two sides of the same coin.

We believe that a world with transparent access to information and knowledge is a fair(er) world.

Technology shall be open. This is why we want to provide value through open-source.

Technology is only useful if it is understood. We aim to make technology accessible to our clients.

Meaningfy Values

At Meaningfy we SMILE



S.M.I.L.E. culture

- **Service:** Going above and beyond to meet the needs of our customers and stakeholders.
- **Mastery:** We strive for continuous learning and mastery, delivering exceptional results and driving innovation.
- **Integrity:** Upholding honesty, ethics, and moral principles in all our actions.
- **Leadership:** Guiding and empowering self and others to reach their full potential.
- **Exploration:** We foster curiosity, creativity, and fearless exploration, uncovering innovative solutions and opportunities for growth.

Service

Going above and beyond to meet the needs of our customers and stakeholders.

At Meaningfy, our value of 'service' represents our commitment to going above and beyond to meet the needs of our customers and stakeholders. It means that we strive to provide exceptional service by truly understanding and addressing their needs. It's about anticipating their requirements and delivering beyond their expectations.

To embody the value of service, we prioritize customer satisfaction and build strong relationships with our customers and stakeholders. We actively listen to their feedback, respond promptly, and take proactive steps to address any concerns. We aim to be a trusted partner, consistently delivering value and solutions that contribute to their success.

Service also extends to our internal relationships. It means supporting and collaborating with our colleagues, departments, and teams, ensuring that we work together seamlessly to deliver the best outcomes for our customers and the organization as a whole.

By embracing the value of service, we demonstrate our dedication to providing exceptional experiences, exceeding expectations, and creating lasting relationships. It sets us apart and positions us as a customer-centric organization. Let's strive to embody this value in all our interactions, actions, and decisions, as it is an essential part of our culture at Meaningfy.

Mastery

We strive for continuous learning and mastery, delivering exceptional results and driving innovation.

At Meaningfy, our value of 'mastery' represents our commitment to continuous learning, achieving excellence in our respective fields, and delivering exceptional results. It's about constantly striving for improvement, honing our skills, and becoming true experts in what we do.

Mastery goes beyond simply acquiring knowledge. It's a mindset of continuous growth and development. We seek to expand our knowledge, stay updated with the latest industry trends, and acquire new skills that enable us to excel in our roles.

By pursuing mastery, we elevate the quality of our work and deliver exceptional results. We take pride in our expertise and craftsmanship, knowing that our dedication to mastery contributes to the success of our projects and the organization as a whole.

Mastery is also closely tied to driving innovation. By continuously learning and pushing ourselves to the limits of our abilities, we unlock new possibilities, generate fresh ideas, and challenge the status quo. It's through our pursuit of mastery that we drive innovation within Meaningfy.

Let's embrace the value of mastery by actively seeking opportunities for growth, supporting each other's development, and fostering a culture of continuous learning. Together, we can achieve remarkable outcomes, push the boundaries of what is possible, and continuously elevate our expertise.

Integrity

Upholding honesty, ethics, and moral principles in all our actions.

At Meaningfy, our value of 'integrity' is fundamental to who we are as individuals and as an organisation. It means upholding honesty, ethics, and moral principles in all our actions, even when faced with difficult decisions or challenging situations.

Integrity is the foundation of trust and credibility. It means being consistent in our words and actions, staying true to our values, and always doing what is right, even if it requires making difficult choices. It's about being transparent, accountable, and responsible for our behaviour and the impact it has on others.

As a team, we commit to maintaining high ethical standards, both individually and collectively. We treat others with respect, fairness, and empathy, fostering an inclusive and supportive work environment. We communicate openly and honestly, and we honor our commitments and promises.

Integrity also extends to our relationships with customers, partners, and stakeholders. We prioritise transparency, build trust, and act in their best interests. We hold ourselves accountable for delivering on our promises and ensuring that our actions align with our values and the expectations of those we serve.

By embodying integrity, we establish Meaningfy as a trustworthy and respected organization. It sets us apart and helps us build strong and lasting relationships with our customers and stakeholders. Let's embrace this value in all our interactions and decisions, fostering a culture of trust, transparency, and ethical conduct. Together, we can create an environment where integrity is not just a value we hold, but a way of life at Meaningfy.

Leadership

Guiding and empowering self and others to reach their full potential.

At Meaningfy, our value of 'leadership' is about more than just a title or position. It's about guiding and empowering ourselves and others to reach our full potential. Leadership is not confined to a select few; it is a quality we can all cultivate within ourselves.

Leadership starts with leading by example. It means taking ownership of our work, demonstrating accountability, and embodying the values we hold. We inspire others through our actions, showing them what is possible and encouraging them to do the same.

Leadership is also about empowering others. We recognize the unique strengths and talents of each team member and provide them with the support, resources, and opportunities they need to thrive. We foster a collaborative environment where everyone's voice is heard and valued.

As leaders, we are responsible for nurturing growth, both for ourselves and others. We encourage continuous learning, provide mentorship, and create an atmosphere where everyone feels safe to take risks and share their ideas.

By embracing the value of leadership, we collectively contribute to a culture of excellence and achievement. We inspire others to bring their best selves to work, build strong relationships, and foster a positive and collaborative environment.

Let's embrace our leadership potential, whether we have a formal leadership title or not. By guiding and empowering ourselves and others, we create a thriving workplace where everyone can reach their full potential. Together, we can achieve remarkable outcomes and make a meaningful impact.

Exploration

We foster curiosity, creativity, and fearless exploration, uncovering innovative solutions and opportunities for growth.

At Meaningfy, our value of 'exploration' represents our commitment to fostering curiosity, creativity, and fearless exploration. It's about embracing a mindset of continuous discovery, uncovering new possibilities, and seeking innovative solutions to challenges.

Exploration is driven by curiosity. We encourage each team member to ask questions, challenge assumptions, and seek more profound understanding. By nurturing our curiosity, we unlock new perspectives and generate fresh ideas that lead to breakthrough innovations.

Creativity is at the heart of exploration. We foster an environment that encourages thinking outside the box, taking risks, and experimenting with different approaches. We value diverse perspectives and believe that the most impactful solutions often arise from exploring unconventional paths.

Fearless exploration means being willing to step into the unknown and embrace ambiguity. We encourage our team to take calculated risks, knowing that failure is a valuable opportunity for learning and growth. We learn from setbacks and apply those lessons to our future endeavours.

Through exploration, we uncover innovative solutions and identify opportunities for growth. It's about pushing boundaries, adapting to change, and continuously challenging ourselves to evolve and improve.

Let's foster a culture of exploration by encouraging curiosity, embracing creativity, and providing space for fearless experimentation. Together, we can uncover new insights, drive innovation, and unlock our full potential. By embracing the value of exploration, we will continuously evolve and stay at the forefront of our industry.

Principles

Principles

1. Focus on the Customer
 - a. Do the right thing for our customers, even when it's difficult.
 - b. We aim to help our customers succeed, going beyond satisfaction to drive their success.
2. Believe in the work
 - a. Accept challenges and embrace meaningful tasks that contribute to our mission.
 - b. Do work only if you understand and believe in its purpose (and usefulness).
3. Orient towards results
 - a. Results matter more than how, when, or where they are produced.
 - b. Focus on achieving meaningful outcomes that drive our mission forward.
4. Focus on impact
 - a. Seek direction on where we are going and align our efforts towards making a meaningful impact.
 - b. Strive to make a difference, knowing that even a flawed effort is better than no effort at all.
5. Share Knowledge and Collaborate
 - a. Recognize that power is gained by sharing knowledge, not hoarding it.
 - b. Foster a culture of knowledge sharing, collaboration, and collective growth.
6. Behave ethically
 - a. Uphold integrity and always do the right thing, even when faced with difficult decisions.
 - b. Embrace transparency and fairness in all our interactions.
7. Balance towards a Physical and Mental well-being
 - a. Prioritize the physical health and well-being.
 - b. Encourage self-care and a balanced lifestyle for sustainable performance.
8. Dare to innovate
 - a. Take risks, experiment, and challenge the existing state of affairs.
 - b. We value a mindset that embraces failure as a stepping stone to success.
9. Embrace Growth and Learning
 - a. Cultivate a culture of continuous growth, where individuals embrace tasks that scare them and seek opportunities to learn and improve.
10. Commit to Mission (and Metrics)
 - a. We are passionately committed to our mission, which drives our existence.
 - b. We are equally committed to our metrics, as they help us make a real impact and further our mission.
11. Encourage Collaboration and Accessibility
 - a. Foster a culture where everyone has access to anyone in the company, promoting collaboration and open communication.
12. Authenticity and Pride
 - a. Cultivate a culture we love and are proud of, where individuals can be their authentic selves and contribute to a positive work environment.
 - b. Embrace diversity, kindness, and respect in all interactions

Code of Conduct

Code of Conduct

We're all here to do amazing work together, but just as important as what we do is how we do it. That's where our Code of Conduct comes in. Think of it as our shared playbook for creating a workplace that's respectful, open, and genuinely enjoyable for everyone.

Here's what we expect from all of us at Meaningfy—employees, contractors, and anyone else on the team:

Our Core Values

- **Assume good intentions:** Approach work relationships with trust and positivity.
- **Work “in the open”:** Be open to teaching and learning from others, sharing knowledge and collaborating effectively.
- **Be respectful and empathetic:** Value differing viewpoints and experiences, ensuring everyone feels heard and included.
- **Give and receive feedback gracefully:** Accept constructive criticism with an open mind, and offer feedback in a spirit of kindness and growth.
- **Maintain a healthy workplace:** Meaningfy prohibits all forms of discrimination and harassment, fostering a safe environment for all.
- **Use professional language:** Refrain from foul language, negative criticism and gossiping to maintain respect and a positive work environment.

Anti-Bribery and Anti-Corruption

- **Zero tolerance for bribery:** Meaningfy strictly prohibits bribery or corruption. Do not offer, solicit, or accept bribes, gifts, or favors that could compromise your integrity.
- **Follow the law and internal policies:** Adhere to all applicable anti-corruption laws and Meaningfy's internal policies to ensure ethical conduct.

Code of Conduct's Violation

If you experience or witness something that violates our Code of Conduct, please report it to your manager. All reports will be reviewed and investigated, and your confidentiality will be protected as much as possible during the investigation.

What happens if there's a violation?

- If an employee is found to have violated the Code of Conduct, it will be documented in their personnel file.
- Depending on the severity of the offense, actions may include mandatory training, a formal reprimand, or termination.
- When possible, the outcome will be shared with the reporting employee.

Important note: Not every interpersonal conflict is a Code of Conduct violation. If you find a colleague rude or difficult to work with, try addressing the issue directly with them or involve your manager. Code of Conduct reports are for serious transgressions - such as illegal or egregiously unethical behavior.

Politics at Work

We respect everyone's right to political expression and activism. However, we avoid political debates on our internal communication systems to maintain focus and respect for everyone's perspectives. Meaningfy as a company does not take public stances on politics unless it directly relates to our business. We ask everyone to respect this approach.

Why It Matters

Our Code of Conduct is about creating a space where we all thrive—together. By adhering to these guidelines, we ensure that Meaningfy is a workplace where respect, collaboration, and integrity are always at the forefront.

Let's make this a place where great work happens because of how we treat each other. If you have any questions or concerns, don't hesitate to reach out to your manager.

Strategy: How we thrive together

At Meaningfy, our strategy is more than a plan—it's the blueprint for how we grow, innovate, and create impact. Our operations are organised into three dynamic divisions: Service Lounge, R&D Workshop, and Start-Up Studio. Together, they form a self-reinforcing ecosystem where consultancy, research, and product development fuel each other to drive sustainable growth and market leadership.

This section provides a clear understanding of how our divisions work independently and collaboratively to achieve Meaningfy's mission. As you read through, you'll see how our strategic principles, like the Flywheel model, ensure efficiency, resilience, and long-term success.

Company structure

How do we organise?



1. **Service Lounge (Division A):** Focused on providing consultancy services to governmental institutions, EU organizations, and mid-sized industrial clients, generating revenue and building expertise.
2. **R&D Workshop (Division B):** Conducts research funded by grants and internal investments, producing innovative knowledge and technological advancements that support consultancy and product development.
3. **Start-Up Studio (Division C):** Develops and validates internal projects, spinning off successful innovations into independent, profitable companies.

These divisions operate in a self-reinforcing ecosystem, where revenue, research, and innovation drive sustainable growth and market impact.

Golden Circle

Why does Meaningfy uses Golden Circle?

Meaningfy uses **Simon Sinek's Golden Circle Model** because it aligns with its mission to create clarity and purpose across its operations. The model ensures that every action Meaningfy takes—whether through services, research, or product innovation—is rooted in a clear understanding of its **Why** (**purpose** or belief behind the organisation), the **How** (unique **methods**, processes, or values that make the organisation stand out) it uses to achieve its goals, and the **What** (tangible **outcomes**, products or services, the organisation offers) it delivers.

Meaningfy's Golden Circle

- **Why:** To empower organisations by **turning raw data into meaningful, actionable knowledge**, enabling informed decisions and fostering a more transparent, interconnected world.
- **How:** By delivering modern innovative solutions, **combining domain expertise, advanced research, and practical tools** to address complex data challenges effectively.
- **What:** **Consultancy services, grounded research, and data-centric tools** that enable interoperability, modernise systems, and create actionable insights.

Division A: Service Lounge

- **Why:** To help organisations make their data meaningful and solve complexity challenges.
- **How:** By delivering expert consultancy in Semantic Web, data management, and semantic interoperability.
- **What:** Tailored data-centric solutions for large organisations (private and public), and specialised outsourcing services.

Division B: R&D Workshop

- **Why:** To innovate and push the boundaries of semantic technologies.
- **How:** By conducting research in Semantic Web and data modelling, funded by grants and internal resources.
- **What:** Advanced research outputs and technical insights to enhance consultancy and product development.

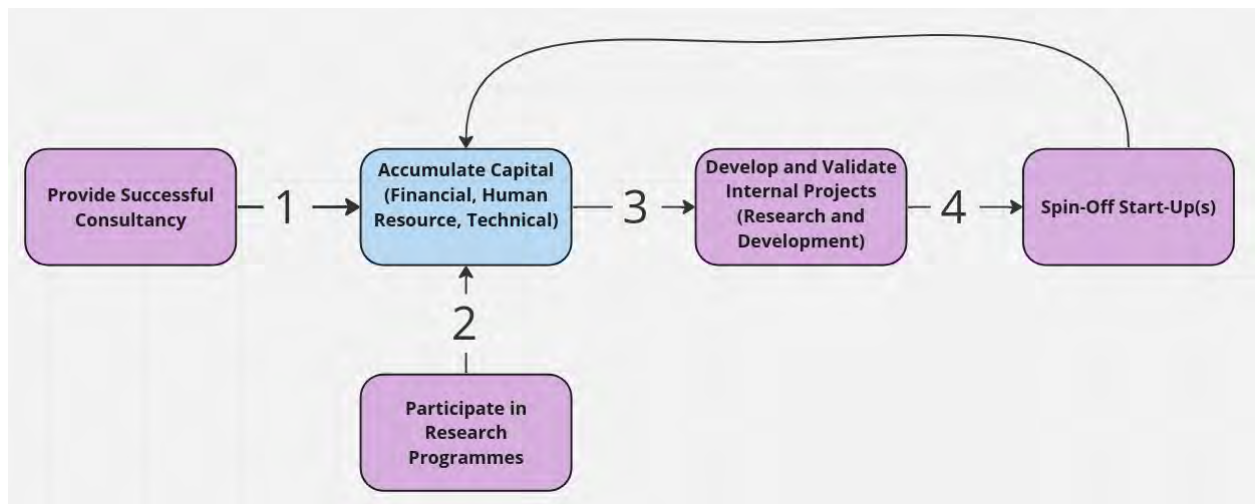
Division C: Start-Up Studio

- **Why:** To turn ideas into impactful, market-ready solutions.
- **How:** By leveraging research and consultancy to develop and scale internal projects.
- **What:** Innovative tools, data-centric products, and profitable spin-offs.

Strategic Plan

What we do

1. Provide consultancy services drives the generation of revenue and resources.
2. Revenue is reinvested in participating in research programs and developing internal projects.
3. Internal projects are validated and spun off into independent start-ups.
4. The spin-offs reinforce the cycle by contributing to consultancy and research programs.



Meaningfy's strategic plan is built around a **sustainable and self-reinforcing model** that integrates **consultancy, research, and innovation**. The company begins by providing high-value consultancy services to governmental institutions, EU organizations, and mid-sized industrial clients. These services, focused on the Semantic Web, and Natural Language Processing (NLP) technologies, in the field of Data Management, to generate revenue, expand expertise, and enhance the company's reputation.

The revenue, along with technical and human capital, is reinvested into developing innovative tools, products, and services. These internal projects are validated and refined to ensure they align with market needs and strategic goals. Successful projects are spun off as independent start-ups, creating profitable companies with their own teams and shareholders. This approach diversifies income streams while building Meaningfy's ecosystem.

Simultaneously, the company actively participates in research programs, securing grants to fund innovative projects and bring cutting-edge knowledge to its internal developments. Meaningfy intentionally avoids external investors, instead committing to a resilient "camel company" model that prioritizes sustainable, self-funded growth over risky, high-scale ambitions.

By combining consultancy, research, and product innovation, the strategic plan ensures that Meaningfy remains financially autonomous, technologically innovative, and positioned as a leader in its niche markets.

Strategic Principles

- **No Investors:** Meaningfy remains self-funded, prioritizing autonomy and long-term sustainability.
- **Camel Company Vision:** The company thrives in both growth and downturn cycles by diversifying revenue and aligning operations with pragmatic goals. **This concept draws on the 'Camel Company' model, which describes self-funded organisations that withstand market fluctuations without external investment.**

- **Open Source and Impact:** Open-source tools and solutions ensure Meaningfy leads with transparency, creating value beyond profit.

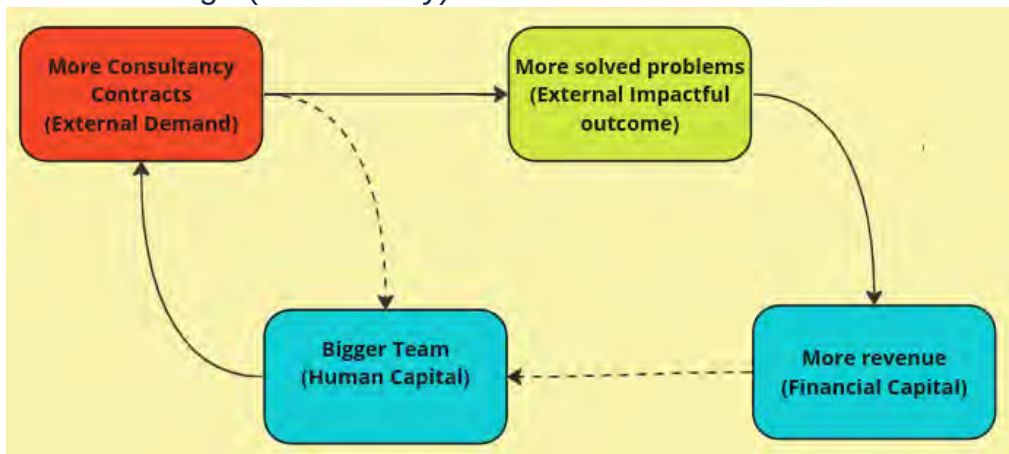
Flywheel Strategy

Why does Meaningfy use the Flywheel model?

A **flywheel** is a strategic concept that represents a self-reinforcing cycle where each element strengthens and accelerates the others, creating sustainable momentum over time. It visualizes how activities, outcomes, and resources are interconnected to drive growth and impact continuously.

We use the flywheel as a strategy tool because it highlights the **circular, compounding nature of success**—focusing on how investments in one area (e.g., consultancy or research) fuel progress in others (e.g., product development or spin-offs). Unlike linear models, the flywheel emphasizes sustainable, long-term growth by showing how each part of the business contributes to and benefits from the cycle, ensuring efficiency, resilience, and scalability.

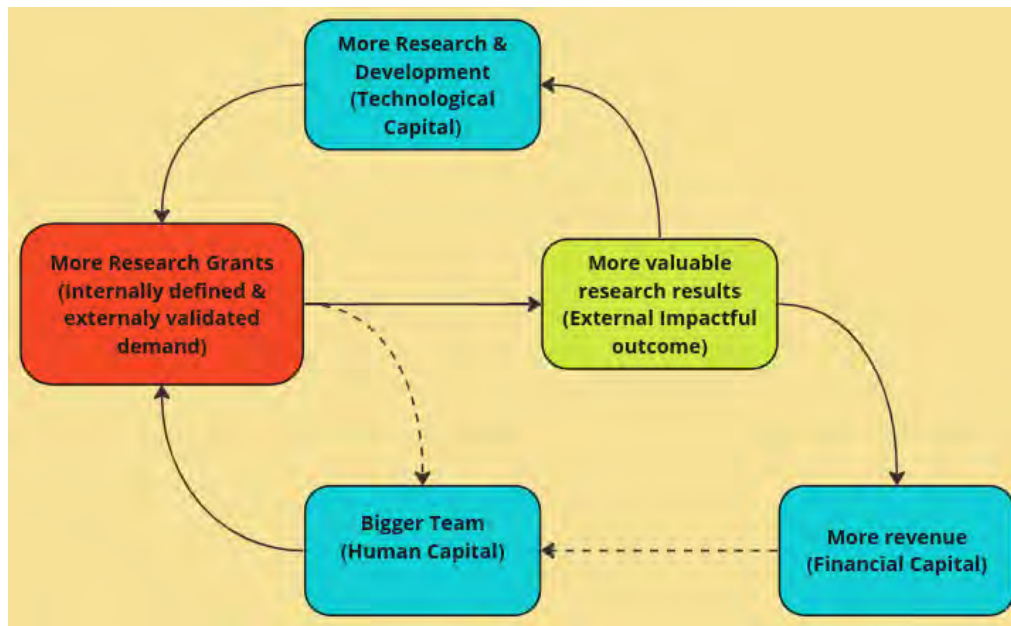
Division A - Service Lounge (consultancy)



The Service Lounge's strategy is built on a powerful, self-reinforcing cycle that drives both growth and impact. As the demand for consultancy services increases, Meaningfy secures more contracts, establishing its role as a trusted problem-solver. Delivering meaningful, impactful solutions to clients not only satisfies immediate needs but also enhances the division's reputation, creating a ripple effect of even greater demand.

This growing success generates additional financial capital, which is strategically reinvested into expanding the team. A bigger, highly skilled team enhances Meaningfy's capacity to address complex challenges and deliver exceptional outcomes, completing the cycle. This flywheel enables the Service Lounge to sustain momentum, scale operations, and deepen its market impact, positioning Meaningfy as a leader in innovative consultancy services.

Division B - R&D Workshop (research)

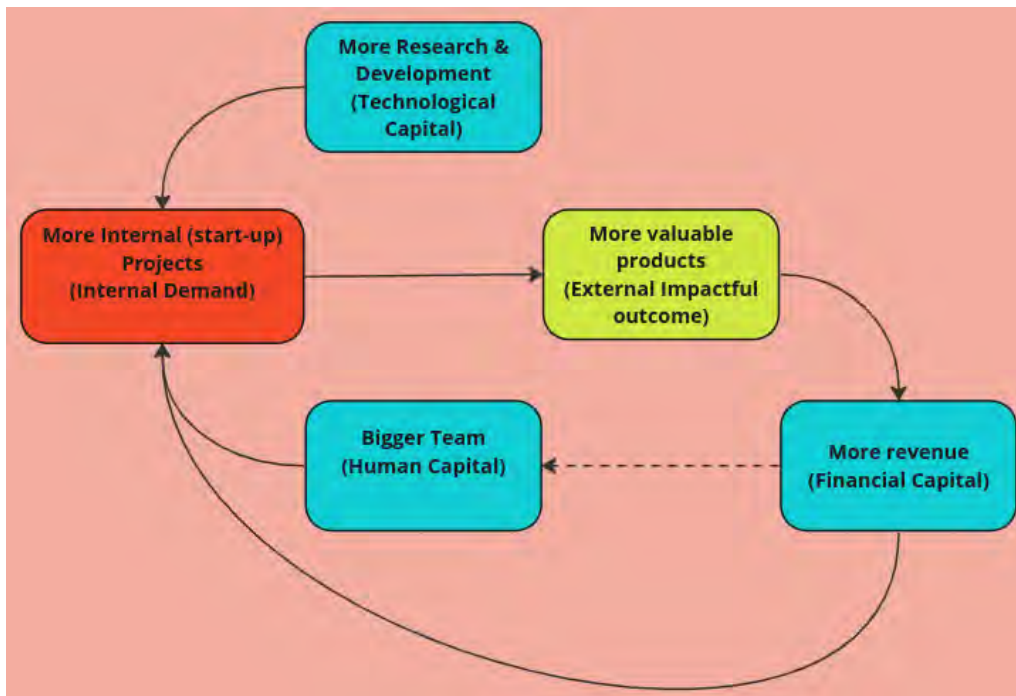


The R&D Workshop (Division B) operates as a critical innovation engine for Meaningfy, leveraging past technological and human capital developed by Division A. With strategic alignment to Meaningfy's vision and business goals, Division B focuses on research projects that not only strengthen the Service Lounge's consultancy services but also lay the groundwork for product innovation in Division C.

The division's funding strategy relies on a combination of academic research grants, internal financing, and business grants. Additionally, partnerships with external stakeholders bring in talented human resources, such as PhD students and post-docs, to work on research projects funded externally. This collaborative model enables Division B to maximize impact while optimizing costs.

Research results feed directly into the operational and commercial goals of other divisions, creating a seamless flow of innovation across Meaningfy. As these outcomes attract further funding and partnerships, Division B perpetuates a self-reinforcing cycle of resource expansion, impactful research, and market leadership.

Division C - Start Up Studio (product development)

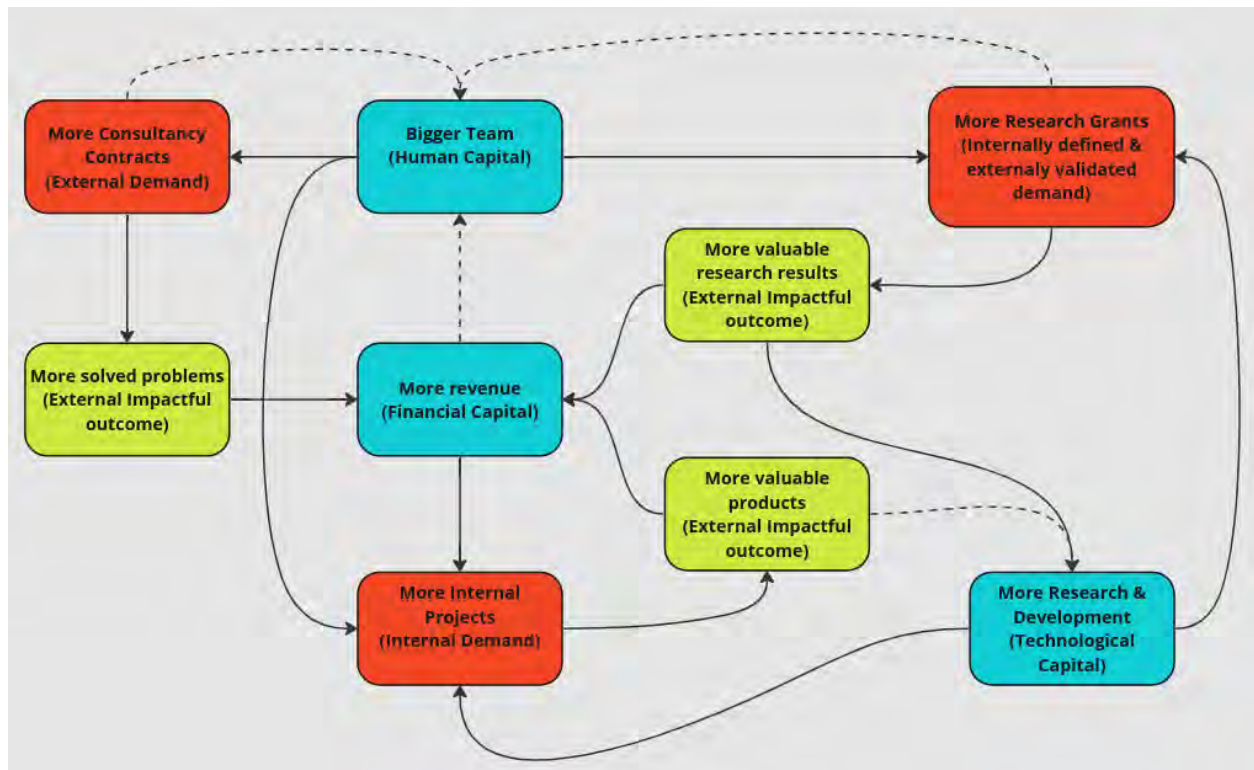


The Start-Up Studio (Division C) is the entrepreneurial engine of Meaningfy, designed to transform internal ideas and R&D insights from Division B into innovative, market-ready products. By leveraging the technological capital developed through Meaningfy's research efforts, Division C ensures that its start-up projects are grounded in cutting-edge knowledge and aligned with both business objectives and market demands.

The division initiates and nurtures internal start-up projects that address pressing challenges and create impactful solutions for customers. These projects are fueled by R&D, and the resulting products generate revenue that is strategically reinvested. This reinvestment expands the team's capabilities and resources, enabling the division to tackle more ambitious projects and scale its efforts further.

Through this self-reinforcing flywheel, the Start-Up Studio continuously drives growth and diversification. By integrating technological innovation, human capital expansion, and revenue reinvestment, Division C secures its position as a cornerstone of Meaningfy's long-term strategy. It not only accelerates Meaningfy's ability to bring visionary products to market but also fosters a culture of innovation and entrepreneurial thinking across the organization.

Unified Flywheel strategy



Meaningfy operates as a highly interconnected ecosystem, where each division plays a critical role in a self-reinforcing cycle of growth, innovation, and impact. The Service Lounge (Division A) addresses client challenges, generating revenue and building Meaningfy's market reputation. This financial capital fuels research efforts in the R&D Workshop (Division B), which produces valuable insights that feed both consultancy services and product development. The Start-Up Studio (Division C) transforms these insights into innovative products, creating new revenue streams and amplifying Meaningfy's market presence.

By seamlessly connecting consultancy, research, and product development, this flywheel ensures that resources, demand, and outcomes reinforce one another. Meaningfy's unified model enables it to scale efficiently, adapt to evolving market needs, and remain a leader in semantic technologies and data interoperability.

Cross-Division Synergies

- **Division A (Service Lounge):**
 - Provides real-world challenges and revenue, feeding insights and funding into R&D (Division B) and internal development (Division C).
- **Division B (R&D Workshop):**
 - Leverages grants and research programs to develop technical solutions that enhance consultancy and support innovation in Division C.
- **Division C (Start-Up Studio):**
 - Turns R&D outputs into market-ready products and creates profitable spin-offs that provide long-term financial returns and strategic value.

Feedback Loops in the Unified Strategy

- **Revenue Flows Across Divisions:**

- Consultancy services, research grants, and spin-off profits generate financial capital that sustains and expands all divisions.
- **Knowledge and Technology Transfer:**
 - Research outcomes from Division B enhance consultancy services (Division A) and enable product innovation in Division C.
- **Reinforcement Through Spin-Offs:**
 - Spin-offs diversify revenue streams, reduce risk, and free Meaningfy to focus on its core mission while creating a lasting ecosystem of impactful companies.

Data Privacy and Information Security Policy

At Meaningfy, we believe that protecting data and maintaining information security is essential to our success and our relationships with clients, partners, and employees. This policy lays the foundation for how we safeguard sensitive information, comply with legal requirements, and foster trust.

Whether you're an employee, contractor, freelancer, or partner, this policy is your guide to understanding and fulfilling your responsibilities in handling Meaningfy's data securely and ethically.

Why This Matters:

- **Compliance:** Ensures we meet GDPR and other data protection regulations.
- **Risk Mitigation:** Reduces the likelihood of data breaches and reputational damage.
- **Trust:** Reinforces our commitment to protecting sensitive information.

Our Principles for Data Privacy

To keep data safe and handled responsibly, here are our guiding principles:

1. **Transparency:** Be clear about how data is collected, used, and shared.
2. **Purpose Limitation:** Only process data for specific, legitimate purposes.
3. **Accuracy and Minimization:** Keep data accurate, up-to-date, and only what's needed.
4. **Privacy by Design:** Incorporate strong security measures in every process or system.
5. **Data Subject Rights:** Enable people to access, correct, or delete their personal data.
6. **Sensitive Data Protection:** Use advanced safeguards (like encryption) when handling sensitive information.
7. **Onward Transfers:** Ensure data shared across systems or jurisdictions is adequately protected.
8. **Storage Limitation:** Retain data only as long as necessary.
9. **Secure Transfers:** Always use secure methods, like encryption, to transfer data.
10. **Accountability:** Regularly review practices, maintain logs, and address any shortcomings.

Information Security: How We Protect Data

Here's what we do to keep Meaningfy's data secure:

- **Data classification:** We categorise all data by sensitivity level (Employee Information, Client Information, Financial Data, Internal Communications, Security Credentials, Research Outputs, Partnership Agreements).
- 1. **Access Control:**
 - Use tools such as multifactor authentication (MFA) and, where available, VPNs for both remote work and internal network access.
 - Only grant access on a need-to-know basis and revoke it when no longer necessary (e.g., regularly audit Google Drive folders, GitHub repos, Jira projects and SSH accounts).
 - **Approved Tools:** Store and share data **only via company-approved platforms** (e.g., Google Workspace, Slack, Confluence, Jira, Airtable).
 - The up-to-date list is maintained by People Operations and can be found in the *Work Environment* section → **General-purpose tools**.
- 2. **System Security:**
 - -

- Use firewalls, anti-malware, and regular updates to protect our systems.
 - Continuously monitor for vulnerabilities and conduct annual OWASP (Open Web Application Security Project)-style penetration tests on applications and APIs.
3. **Data Protection:**
 - Encrypt data at rest and during transfers.
 - Separate production from testing environments, and ensure backups are available.
 4. **Third-Party Oversight:**
 - Assess third-party services for risks.
 - Require subcontractors handling Meaningfy data to follow these same standards.
 5. **Physical Security:**
 - Restrict data access to secure, approved environments.
 6. **Incident Response:**
 - Report breaches or potential issues within 72 hours to your line manager or via the Slack, .
 - Act swiftly to minimize risks and prevent future incidents.

What's Expected of You

As part of the Meaningfy team, here's what you need to do:

1. **Compliance:**
 - Follow the principles and standards laid out in this policy.
 - Complete annual security awareness training.
(programme under development by People Operations; details will be announced in dedicated Slack channel)
2. **Be Organized:**
 - Keep track of open-source software (OSS), access logs, and any tools you use.
 - Document any security measures you implement.
3. **Ethical Data Handling:**
 - Only use Meaningfy or client data for its intended purpose.
 - Inform Meaningfy of any significant contributions you make to OSS to ensure compliance.
4. **Report Breaches Immediately:**

If you notice a potential or actual data breach, **report it within 72 hours** by Slack DM or email to **your line manager, the Project Shipper, the Head of Operations, or the CEO**.

 - **Project Shipper, the Head of Operations, or the CEO.**

Use whichever channel is fastest; the first recipient will escalate according to the incident-response playbook.

Accountability

By being part of the Meaningfy team, you commit to:

1. Reading and understanding this policy.
2. Complying with the standards it outlines.
3. Reporting breaches or incidents promptly.

Non-Compliance

Not following this policy has consequences:

1. It may lead to disciplinary action, including termination.

2. It could result in damage to Meaningfy's reputation and finances.
3. Legal repercussions may apply under GDPR and other data protection laws.

Policy Updates

This policy isn't set in stone—it will be reviewed annually or whenever needed to reflect changes in regulations or best practices.

Final Note

For day-to-day guidance on where to store files and how to collaborate, see *Work Environment* → **Communication channels** and **General-purpose tools**.

By following this policy, we ensure that Meaningfy continues to be a trusted partner and employer, committed to data protection and ethical practices. It's not just about compliance—it's about doing the right thing for our clients, our company, and each other.

Let's make Meaningfy a secure and trusted workplace for everyone!

How we work

⚠️ *How we work is a blend of two methodologies: SCRUM and Shaping Up.*

Remotely

We've been remote since we started. We don't care where team members choose to live and work, just that they're here to do great work on exceptional products, alongside a world-class team.

You can work from anywhere, but please be sure to inform your managers when you move - especially across country borders.

Office Hours and Availability

As a 100% remote company, we prioritize flexibility while maintaining a consistent structure for collaboration and communication. You are expected to work **8 hours** per day. To ensure that team members are accessible for coordination, we have established specific "*Core Office Hours*" during which employees are expected to be available at their computers and responsive.

The Core Office Hours are between **9:00 to 12:00 CET and 14:00 to 16:00 CET** on weekdays.

Any deviations from the Core Office Hours should be discussed and agreed upon in advance with your manager.

Balanced

We limit ourselves to a **40-hour work week**. Keeping our hours at work limited forces us to prioritise the work that really matters. A healthy amount of sleep and a rich and rewarding life outside of work should not be squandered for a few more hours at work.

There are occasions when teams or individuals need to work off-hours for on-call, maintenance, or emergencies. This time preferably should not be in addition to your normal working hours. Use your discretion to take time off to make up for the additional hours you put in during the week.

Conversely, when you need to run errands, attend doctor appointments or dedicate to unexpected life events, you are expected to make-up for this time in the evening or the weekend as long as it is in your productive hours and does not affect your balance.

Consistent deviation from the Core Office Hours, such as regularly working late evenings or during the night, is considered unproductive and is generally discouraged. This practice can lead to burnout and decreased team cohesion. Exceptions may be made on a case-by-case basis, with prior approval from the manager.

Such exceptional events must be notified to your team as much in advance as possible.

Special Circumstances

While we appreciate dedication, we do not encourage working excessive hours, such as pulling all-nighters, especially before major deadlines. We believe in sustainable work practices and encourage proper planning and time management to meet project goals without last-minute rushes.

By adhering to these guidelines, we aim to foster a healthy work environment that supports productivity, work-life balance, and effective team collaboration.

With managers of one

We rely on everyone at Meaningfy to do a lot of self-management. People who do this well are managers of one, and we expect everyone to embody this principle.

That means setting your own direction when one isn't given; and determining what needs to be done, and doing it, without waiting for someone to tell you to. A manager of one will spend their time well when left to their own devices. There's always more work to be done, always more initiatives to kick off, and always more improvement to be had.

A manager of one is someone who comes up with their own goals and executes them. They don't need heavy direction. They don't need daily check-ins. They do what a manager would do — set the tone, assign items, determine what needs to get done, etc. — but they do it by themselves and for themselves.

Managers of one set their own direction. When you leave them alone, they surprise you with how much they've gotten done. They don't need a lot of handholding or supervision.

Linear planning & Agile execution

Our project management methodology combines the advantages of **Linear planning (waterfall)** with those of an **Agile execution**. This hybrid approach is specifically designed to establish a clear project vision and structure, incorporating well-defined goals and objectives, while retaining the flexibility to adapt to changes, manage risks, and integrate continuous feedback throughout the project life-cycle, aligning with the dynamic nature of a project.

Clean & craftsman-like

We believe that professionalism and **clean work** transcends job titles or specific roles.

Clean is an approach, an attitude, and a commitment to excellence that every team member should embody.

Inspired by the principles laid out in *The Clean Coder* by Robert C. Martin, we encourage every employee to adopt a **craftsman-like attitude** to their work, whether or not they are directly involved in coding.

Attention to detail

Just as a master craftsman takes pride in their work, we expect our team members to produce work that is thorough, polished, and of high quality. This means paying attention to the small details that collectively contribute to the overall success of our projects. Strive to leave every task or project better than you found it, regardless of your role.

Continuous learning and practice

True craftsmanship requires continual practice and a dedication to honing your skills. At Meaningfy, we support and encourage ongoing learning. Take the initiative to improve your expertise outside of daily tasks, whether that's through reading, training, or hands-on practice. Your professional development is not just a benefit to the company—it's your responsibility.

Clear communication

Clear, direct communication is crucial. Like in coding, where ambiguity can lead to bugs and errors, unclear communication can derail projects. Be clear in your commitments, be honest about your limitations, and always communicate any blockers or concerns as soon as they arise.

Commitment to Quality

Delivering under pressure should never come at the expense of quality. Whether you're coding, designing, managing, or supporting operations, your work should reflect a commitment to high standards. Follow best practices, seek feedback, and never compromise on the integrity of your work.

Professionalism

Being professional means following a clear and structured methodology in your work. At Meaningfy, every task and activity is guided by a specific methodology. If you're unsure about the methodology you should be using, pause and consult with your manager to clarify it before proceeding. Our methodologies are not one-size-fits-all; they are carefully adapted to fit our unique context and needs. We draw inspiration from industry best practices, but we also innovate and refine our approaches to ensure they work best for us.

By embracing these principles, we ensure that our work at Meaningfy is not just completed, but crafted with care and excellence, setting us apart as true professionals in our respective fields.

Project anatomy

Our work is organised into projects. Each project begins with a charter, is shaped before execution into deliverables, and is shipped to stakeholders (internal or external).

Before execution begins, work is shaped so that builders can proceed effectively.

Shipping starts once deliverables are ready. After deliverables are shipped and accepted by stakeholders, the project is closed.

Customer success management and communication are continuous activities, beginning at project inception and extending beyond project closure.



Project Conception

Project Charter

We commence by establishing a **Project Charter (PC)**, which is a formal document used by the business stakeholders delineating the project's **purpose, scope, stakeholders, objectives, and comprehensive plan**.

For *internal projects*, PC is a short document listing the essential ingredients of a project:

- purpose (why we do it),
- scope (what is in, what is NOT in),
- stakeholders (who is involved and how),
- objectives (what will be materially achieved at the end), and
- comprehensive project roadmap (the roadmap, work breakdown structure, activities, deadlines, etc)
- requirements specifications (WP level problem description, proposed approach, and scope)

For *external projects* (those we do for our clients), the PC, is the Offer we provide our client in response to a Request for an Offer (RfO). It contains all of the ingredients of an internal project and in addition, **a statement of RfO understanding, meetings schedule, the team structure and a financial offer**. Other sections may be included as per the client requirement.

We use Gantt charts (in Smartsheet app) to draw and calculate most projects with activity inter-dependencies. For simpler projects, we may skip Gantt charts and use just a table of activities, deliverables, and deadlines.

Project Roadmap - Work Breakdown Structure

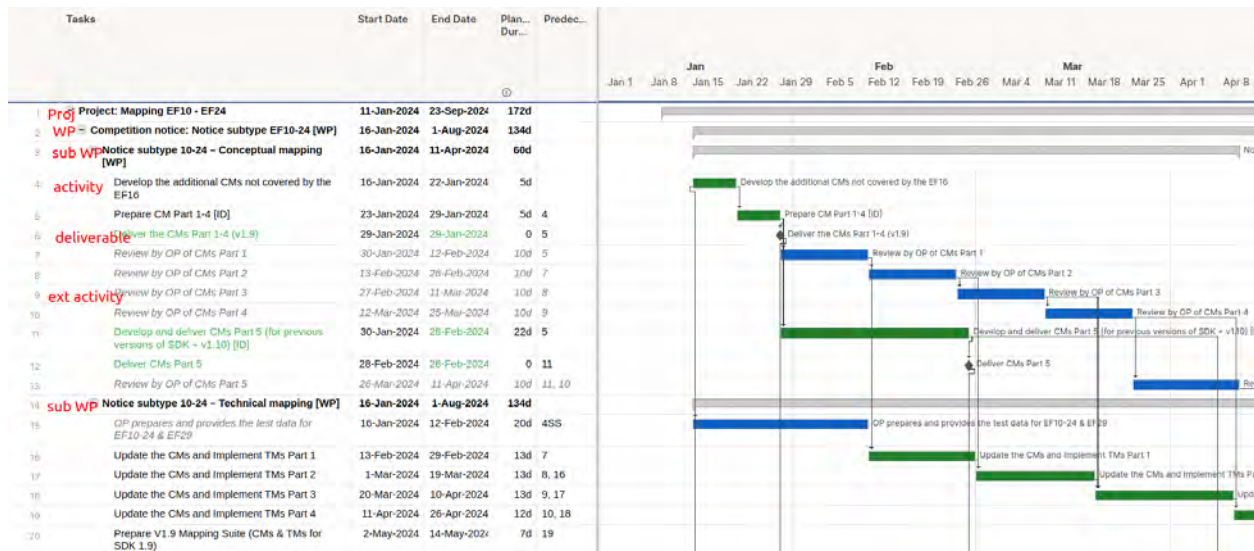
We adopt a **linear planning** method, setting a preliminary **Roadmap** that outlines the project's vision, activities, and milestones. The Roadmap is organised as a Gantt diagram depicting a **Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)** which decomposes a project into manageable **Work Packages (WP)**, **Milestones or Deliverables (D)** and corresponding activities, approximating scope and fixing the resources needed.

The WBS is organised as a tree of elements at each level accomodating a different element type. Each element has a start, and end, and a duration. In addition the WPs, activities and milestones, use dependencies on other elements (for example). The WBS anatomy is as follows

- Project (root node, use project ID and title)
 - [WP.x] work package (title, 10 words)
 - [WP.x.y] sub-work package
 - Activity title (or short task description, 10-20 words)
 - [D.x.z] Milestone (when a Deliverable is ready for shipping, title 5-10 words)

Each Work Package has at least one activity and at least one deliverable.

For example a project could be structured like this



Requirements specifications

The PC specifies also the general approach and what will be achieved by each work package. These specifications are used for business level discussions, negotiations and understanding.

In case of projects for external clients, the requirements are specified in the RfO and the Offer contains a description of the approach to fulfill those requirements. To ensure the overall consistency and project completeness a **Requirements Matrix** is provided.

In case of internal projects, the PC shall specify for each WP what are the requirements and what approach shall be taken at addressing those.

The WP requirements specifications are used to shape up the work for the project team.

Activity estimation with PERT method

In complex or risky projects, each activity is estimated with PERT method. The computed expected time (t_e) is used as the planned duration for an activity. If necessary the planned duration can include also a factor of computed standard deviation ($x * \sigma_{t_e}$) of time to accommodate risk overheads.

The estimated WPs duration represent the business Appetite for that set of activities to reach the desired outcomes or deliverables.

Only the WBS activities receive PERT estimates, the WPs and project elements aggregate the duration of the comprised activities.

PERT defines four types of time required to accomplish an activity:

- *optimistic time*: the minimum possible time required to accomplish an activity (o), assuming everything proceeds better than is normally expected
- *pessimistic time*: the maximum possible time required to accomplish an activity (p), assuming everything goes wrong (but excluding major catastrophes).
- *most likely time*: the best estimate of the time required to accomplish an activity (m), assuming everything proceeds as normal.
- *expected time*: the best estimate of the time required to accomplish an activity (t_e), accounting for the fact that things don't always proceed as normal (the implication being that the expected time is the average time the task would require if the task were repeated on a number of occasions over an extended period of time).

- *standard deviation of time* : the variability of the time for accomplishing an activity (σ_{te}).

Agile project execution

For project execution, we apply the Agile methodology, that is a blend of two methodologies: **SCRUM** and **Shape Up**.

We aim to ensure timely and frequent deliverables, adaptability to changes, possible client needs, and fixed cost contract constraints. Agile's iterative process ensures continuous feedback and incremental development, aligning closely with our commitment to delivering value at every stage of the project.

After the Project Charter (PC) has been created and agreed upon, the work on the project is **kicked off** in a dedicated meeting.

Work execution planning

Besides the PC, which establishes the project strategic plan, a tactical plan is needed for executing each Work package.

This planning activity is conducted before the project kick-off for the first two-three Sprints, and then on a continuous basis ahead of each Sprint.

Deliverables are Epics

The Work Packages devised in the planning phase are conceptualised as Epics in the execution phase, which are further broken down into Tasks and Stories. We keep dual vocabulary because sometimes, a WP may be further broken down into more than one Epic.

It is a good idea to account for every important requirement or functionality within the project as a Story. This however may not be always possible, especially if the execution approach differs conceptually from that in the project RfO.

Work shaping

Each Epic encompasses a well-defined work description, scope, and delineation of risks, called "**work shape**". The work shape is written based on the requirements specified in the Project Charter, which is agreed upon with the business stakeholders before commencement.

Unlike SCRUM method that rely on "**estimates**", we set an "**appetite**" for each Epic, fixing the execution time while allowing for scope adjustments to ensure the main objectives are met.

Epic appetite is set in number of weeks needed to ship the work.

The work shape is *specific*, *traceable*, and *achievable* within established appetite. This approach fosters efficiency and focus, ensuring that essential features are prioritised and delivered within the agreed time-frame.

Sprint (Cycles)

At Meaningfy we work in 2-week cycles called sprints. This fixed cadence serves to give us an internal sense of urgency, to keep projects from ballooning, and to provide us with a regular interval to make decisions about what we're working on.

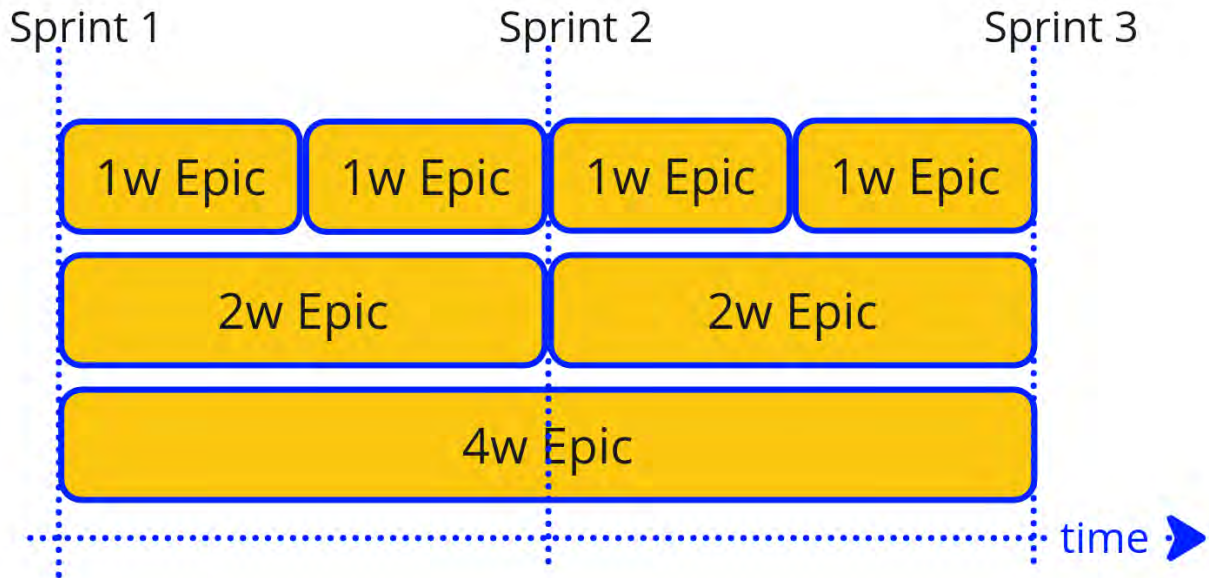
Sprints are sequentially interdependent, complementing each other until the project is finished.

Our sprint structure is particularly important for the product/project teams, since they approach feature and product/project development with scope and budget in mind up front. The implementation of an Epic (originally planned as Work Package) may span across one or multiple Sprints, allowing for focused development and review within predefined periods.

All teams operate on the same 2-week cadence. The sprint is organised as follows:

- Starting - first week Tuesday morning
- Ending - second week Friday evening
- Planning & Kickoff reporting - third week Monday
- Demos & Heartbeat reporting - second week Friday

Meaningful Sprints are more aligned to SCRUM and thus different from the Shape Up Cycles. An Epic thus, depending on its appetite, is executed in less than a sprint, or one, two or more sprints, as depicted below.



Deep work and Cooldown

Sprints can be of two types: *deep work* and *cooldown sprints*.

Deep work sprints are dedicated to focused, uninterrupted work on well shaped work. We commit to accomplishing an Epic (or a set of Epics) in a time frame and we honor it. We do NOT allow a team to get interrupted or pulled away to work on something else. It breaks the commitment of doing focused, deep work. It breaks the momentum.

Every 1-3 deep work sprints there is a **cooling down**. That's when product/project teams deal with bugs, when everyone writes up what they've worked on, and when teams decide what to tackle next. Sometimes big batch projects extend into cool down, but we try to avoid that. Sometimes we may need two consecutive cooldown sprints, but that is exceptional.

Managing Out-of-Contract Improvements

Here is our approach for managing tasks related to improving, maintaining, and extending project tools that were not specifically requested by the client and, therefore, are not included in the contract scope.

Creating a Dedicated EPIC – “Improvements Outside Contract”

1. The “**Improvements Outside Contract**” EPIC is **not a general rule** but a **case-by-case approach**. Each instance must be discussed individually for each project, and if approved by Eugen and Thomas, we can create such an EPIC.
2. The EPIC **should be created within the project**, and not in Meaningfy PM, to maintain **clarity and accountability** at the team level.
3. Every EPIC must be **well-defined** and have a **clear appetite (time budget allocated)**. A proper **EPIC PITCH** should be prepared according to our internal guidelines to avoid accumulating unplanned activities that might impact project deliveries.
4. Activities included in the EPIC must be **validated at the conceptual level by Eugen and Thomas** to ensure efficient and appropriate resource allocation.
5. We must **ensure that these activities cannot initially be integrated into one of the existing WPs** under the current contract.

Key Considerations:

1. **Small improvement tasks can be absorbed by project budgets** and included in the relevant EPICs or Stories that correlate with an active WP in the contract.
2. If an improvement task **cannot be absorbed into an active EPIC/WP**, it means the scope is too large, or the idea is too ambitious, and should be handled through a **dedicated new EPIC – “Improvements Outside Contract”**.
3. For this EPIC, we apply the **same rules and approach** as for all other EPICs, ensuring an **EPIC PITCH is created according to our internal standard**.
4. All stories, including continuous improvement efforts, **must have a defined appetite** to ensure they do not delay active project deliveries and can be managed within the given timeframe.

Project shipping

Introduction

The Shipping Phase marks the culmination of our team's efforts, where the project transitions from creation to delivery. This phase is critical for ensuring that all deliverables meet client expectations, contractual agreements, and the highest quality standards. It is not merely about transferring outputs but about guaranteeing satisfaction, compliance, and the project's ultimate success.

Delivery Manager - The Shipper

The Delivery Manager, often referred to as "The Shipper," plays a pivotal role during this phase. This role involves meticulous oversight of the delivery process, ensuring smooth coordination between internal teams, clients, and stakeholders.

Key Responsibilities:

1. Ensuring Quality:

- Conduct comprehensive inspections of all deliverables to confirm they meet contractual specifications and the agreed-upon quality standards.
- Address any discrepancies promptly to ensure compliance before delivery.

2. Managing Logistics:

- Oversee the timely delivery of work packages to the client, as defined in the contract.
- Coordinate with internal teams to ensure all delivery details are addressed, including preparation of handover materials and scheduling delivery sessions.
- Validate that each deliverable matches the contractually agreed specifications before delivery.

3. Client Handover:

- Facilitate a seamless handover of project outcomes, ensuring all documentation and deliverables are presented in an organized and professional manner.
- Act as the primary point of contact for the client during this phase, ensuring clear communication and addressing any final concerns.

4. Reporting:

- Report to the Project Owner and Business Developer, providing updates on the shipping progress and client feedback.

The Shipping Process

The Shipping Phase involves the following key steps, ensuring that all aspects of delivery are executed flawlessly:

1. Contractual Validation:

- Review the deliverables against the contractual agreement.
- Address and rectify any misalignments before proceeding to the client.

2. Documentation and Preparation:

- Ensure all work documentation is complete, including user manuals, project reports, and README files.
- Package deliverables for formal presentation to the client.

3. **Delivery Scheduling:**

- Schedule each work package delivery in accordance with the contractually agreed milestones.
- Align delivery dates and time slots with the client's availability and overall project plan.
- Request and obtain written approval for any change to a scheduled delivery date, documenting the justification in the project log.
- Confirm participant attendance for each handover or demonstration session.
- Arrange any follow-up sessions required for effective utilisation of delivered work packages.

4. **Delivery Execution:**

- Transport deliverables securely to the client.
- Present the deliverables in a professional manner, ensuring clarity and transparency.

5. **Client Demonstration:**

- Organize a walkthrough or demonstration session to showcase the deliverables.
- Address client questions and feedback promptly, ensuring satisfaction.

6. **Final Approval and Handover:**

- Secure final approval from the client, marking the completion of the project.
- Provide any necessary training or guidance for utilizing the deliverables effectively.

Roles and Reporting Structure

- **Delivery Manager:** This position oversees the entire shipping process, ensuring quality and client satisfaction. It reports directly to the Project Owner and Business Developer.
- **Internal Teams:** Support the Delivery Manager by finalizing documentation, preparing deliverables, and addressing last-minute changes.
- **Client Representatives:** Collaborate with the Delivery Manager to ensure deliverables meet expectations.

Key Values of the Shipping Phase

- **Transparency:** Every process step is communicated clearly to the client, ensuring alignment and trust.
- **Accountability:** Deliverables are thoroughly checked against contract specifications, leaving no room for errors.
- **Client Satisfaction:** The client experience is prioritized, making this phase as seamless and positive as possible.

Redelivery Policy

Purpose:

Establish a clear, repeatable process for re-delivery work driven by client or operational feedback, without compromising the traceability or stability of the original Epics.

Summary:

Redelivery refers to the additional work required after a client reviews a delivered component and requests updates, corrections, or extensions beyond the initial delivery.

A new EPIC is required if new scope / extra work:

- new elements are added
- the scope is extended
- the effort is significantly higher
- the original appetite is exceeded
- it becomes a new iteration of work
- In this case, we also need a new Shape Up process and an Epic Pitch.

We can stay in the same EPIC only if:

- the feedback is minor
- it does not extend the scope
- it fits within the original appetite
- no new requirements are introduced

1. Definitions

- **Initial Epic:** The package of functionality approved at the start of a build cycle, with a fixed appetite (allocated time & resources).
- **Done:** Status applied once an Epic's deliverables have been shipped.
- **Redelivery:** Any rework required when the initial deliverable is not accepted or needs adjustments beyond the original appetite.

2. Procedure

2.1 Closing the Initial Epic

- At the end of the first delivery, mark the Epic **Done** and close it—regardless of final acceptance.

2.2 Triggering Redelivery

- If feedback or change requests exceed the scope and appetite of the closed Epic, initiate a redelivery.

2.3 Creating a New Epic

- Open a dedicated Epic for redelivery only, with a new appetite and pitch.
- **Minimum fields:**
 - **Title:** "[Component] Redelivery – D?.?"
 - **Summary:** "Rework as per client/operational feedback"

2.4 Logging Activities

- Create **all** sub-tasks and stories **exclusively** in the new Epic.
- **Do not** open new tickets or log additional hours against the closed (Done) Epics.

2.5 Traceability

- In the new Epic's comments, reference the original Epic and state the reason for redelivery.

3. Time-Logging Rules

- Any unlogged hours **prior** to an Epic being marked Done may be entered retrospectively against that Epic.
- **All** hours relating to redelivery work **must** be logged only in the newly created Epic, from the moment it is opened.

4. Post-Redelivery Review

- **Lessons Learned (default)**
 - Within **5 working days** of finishing a redelivery, the team captures:
 - what worked
 - what didn't
 - immediate improvement actions
 - Format: concise bullet list, linked to the redelivery Epic.
- **Post-Mortem (when required)**
 - If the redelivery **exceeds the new appetite** or uncovers critical issues, run a formal root-cause analysis.
 - Output: structured report (timeline, findings, contributing factors, actions), attached to the Epic and archived on the intranet.
- **Responsibilities**
 - **Shipper / Shaper:** schedules and facilitates the review / post-mortem.
 - **Delivery Crew:** provides data and insights.
 - **Operational Manager:** stores the documentation, broadcasts key takeaways, and updates any affected processes.

5. Responsibilities

- **Shipper/ Shaper :** Approves closure of initial Epics and triggers creation of the redelivery Epic.
- **Shipper/ Shaper:** Creates sub-tasks/stories and logs all redelivery activities according to this policy.
- **Operational Manager:** Monitors compliance with this policy compliance and maintains the intranet/reporting platform.

Project Rituals

Since we work asynchronously and remotely, **it's important to radiate information** about what we're working on. We have 5 chief mechanisms for doing that.

- Daily Stand-up
- Project Kick-off
- Sprint Planning
- Sprint Demos
- Monthly Heartbeat

These 5 mechanisms work together to free individuals and teams to run their days and sprints with confidence and independence. We have six opportunities per year to make big decisions about what to work on, and the rest of the time should chiefly be spent carrying out those short-term plans. By having clear expectations for communication, it's easier for everyone to build trust in where we're going and why.

Heartbeats and Kickoffs are assigned to team leads or delivery leads well in advance of every sprint. Heartbeats, kickoffs, and automatic check-in answers can all be found in the Project Confluence Space.

Note on Annotations:

Throughout this section, you will see the annotations **[I]** and **[E]** associated with these rituals:

- **[I] Internal:** These rituals are conducted exclusively within the team and do not involve the client. They focus on internal planning, communication, and team alignment.
- **[E] External:** These rituals involve the client, ensuring transparency, gathering feedback, and maintaining alignment with client expectations.

Daily stand-UP [I]

You will be asked these two questions every day in a short Stand-UP meeting.

What did you accomplish yesterday?

What goals are you pursuing today?

You should describe what you're working on and give some context about why you're working on it or why it's important. This is an excellent occasion to ask for help, call for sync meetings with colleagues and make important team announcements.

We organise stand-up Slack Huddles at the beginning of every day (at 9:00 CET) and expect everyone to be there in time. While Meaningfy is below 15 people, there is one stand up for everyone. When we grow beyond we will break up into smaller stand-up groups. This is the chance to stay up to date with what other colleagues are working on. Even if it does not concern you directly you may be asked to help with the project in the future or you may decide to join the project if yours has ended.

Project Kick-off [E]

Every project begins with a kick-off meeting, organized and facilitated by the project Shipper. This meeting involves the team, the project owner, and other stakeholders, setting the stage for immediate commencement of work.

For large projects, two kick-off meetings shall be organized:

1. An **internal kick-off meeting** is conducted before the client-facing meeting. This allows the team to prepare thoroughly, align on the project scope, goals, and execution plan, and address any uncertainties.
2. An **external client kick-off meeting** follows the internal session, where the prepared plan is presented to the client and stakeholders. This ensures a unified and professional approach during the external meeting.

Before the kick-off meeting, in the Project Conception phase, the following must be completed:

1. **Project Charter:** The Project Charter is written by the project owner and revised by the Shaper, Shipper, and other stakeholders. This document outlines the project's scope, goals, and key details.
2. **Stakeholder Review:** Management, the team, and other stakeholders have reviewed the Project Charter.
3. **Approval and Resources:** Management has approved the project, provided the necessary budget, and confirmed team availability.
4. **Epic Shaping:** The Shaper has shaped at least one or two Epics to cover the first sprint.
5. **Sprint Draft:** The Shipper has prepared the draft plan for the first sprint.
6. **Kick-off Presentation:** The Shipper has prepared the project kick-off presentation.
7. **Team Notification:** The team has been informed of the scheduled project kick-off.

During the kick-off meeting, the project is presented to the team, management, and other stakeholders. The meeting agenda includes:

1. **Project Overview:** Background, scope, and goals of the project are discussed.
2. **Roles and Responsibilities:** Clarity on team roles and responsibilities is provided.
3. **Risks and Challenges:** Anticipated project risks and challenges are identified and discussed.
4. **Execution Approach:** The methodology and supporting ceremonies to be used are listed and explained.

By the end of the kick-off meeting, the team should have a clear action plan for the next steps. The first sprint draft plan is presented to all participants, and a Sprint Planning meeting with the team can follow immediately after the kick-off.

Work Shaping and Sprint Drafting Timing:

For complex projects, work shaping and sprint drafting can occur after the external kick-off with the client (and management). The team is given 1-2 weeks to shape the Epics and plan the sprint tasks in detail. This approach allows sufficient time to refine the execution plan based on discussions in the kick-off meeting and ensures the team is fully prepared before starting the work implementation phase.

Formalities:

- Project kickoff presentation slides - by the Shipper for the client (and the management) and the team
- Project kickoff meeting - by the Shipper for the client (and the management) and the team
- Meeting Minutes - for the management (and the client)
- Official email to the client

Sprint Planning [I]

What are the sprint objectives?

How they contribute to the Epic goals and the overall project?

Each sprint the team is aligned and familiar with the work to be done. The Shipper drafts a Sprint Kickoff page, specifying the Epics planned for implementation. These Epics, shaped in advance by the Shaper, come with a complete Pitch.

The Shipper consults the project roadmap, reviews outcomes from previous sprints presented in the Heartbeat, and considers any changes in scope, schedule, or team composition.

The Shipper organizes a meeting to present the plan, ensuring the team understands the shaped work for each Epic. This meeting is crucial for clarifying, adjusting, and summarizing the work scheduled for the upcoming sprint.

The team create Stories that partition the Epic work and orders them in the Hill Chart. The Stories have business value and are not mere tasks. See the page on working with Jira for more explanations on how to conceptualise Stories, Tasks and Epics.

Any necessary modifications to the draft kickoff page are made during the meeting.

The Shipper finalises and submits the Kickoff report before the first day of the sprint, typically by Monday evening.

This process ensures that all team members are on the same page and ready to start the sprint with clear, well-defined objectives.

Formalities:

- Sprint plan (kickoff report) - by the Shipper for the management
- Sprint planning meeting (up to 2h) - with the Shipper for the Team
- Epic Hill chart bootstrapped - by the Shipper and the team

Work in Progress Demo [I]

At the end of the Sprint, the WIP Demo allows the team to present completed or partial results to the Shaper and other stakeholders as needed. This is an excellent opportunity to gather early feedback and draft content for the Heartbeat report.

The Shaper organizes the demo meeting before the new sprint is planned, ensuring that the entire team is present. Key stakeholders are invited as needed.

The demo can be run from development environments and does not need to showcase fully shipped products. Even if the work is only partially complete, present what you have. This transparency helps in maintaining smooth communication and short feedback cycles.

The Shaper facilitates the meeting and takes notes. The team is responsible for presenting the work done during the sprint.

Though demos are optional, they are strongly encouraged to ensure alignment and receive valuable input early in the process.

Formalities:

- Demo meeting (up to 1h) - Shipper Facilitates, by the Team for the Shaper
- Demo Meeting Minutes - by the Shipper for the Shaper (and other stakeholders)

Deliverable Demo [E]

The deliverable can cover one or multiple Epics

Concides with deadlines / milestones

Whener possible combine Deliverable Demo with the Monthly Heartbeat meeting

The work has been completly shipped (implemented, documented, tested, packages, deployed)

The shipped work must be timestamped, there shall be a Git commit hash associated, a Git tag associated, if outside Git then it must be a Read-Only document or Zip archive attached to an email, etc.

Formalities:

- Official email to the client pointing to the deliverables -
- Deliverable demo meeting - for the management (and the client)
- Deliverable Meeting Minutes -
- Deliverable presentation -
- Official email to the client (and management) with the meeting minutes and the presentation.

Monthly Heartbeat (Progress Update) [E]

Monthly Heartbeat is also known as monthly progress report, monthly status update report

The Monthly Heartbeat is a mandatory, concise meeting for every team, due on the first Friday of each month. It's a 30-45 minute session aimed at providing a clear status update to management and clients.

The Shipper writes a crisp Heartbeat report which covers the past, present, and future aspects of the project.

The Shipper organizes the Heartbeat meeting, inviting the Shaper and other stakeholders as necessary.

Meeting minutes are kept by the Shipper to document feedback, decisions, or changes to the scope, priorities, or team composition.

In the meeting the following aspects are presented

1. **Project Goals and Roadmap:** The team reminds attendees of the project's goals and roadmap as defined in the Project Charter. Any changes in scope or deadlines are also highlighted.
2. **Work Summary:** The team summarises and celebrates the work completed in the previous month, ensuring alignment with the Project Roadmap (and Sprint Kickoffs).
3. **Work in Progress and Challenges:** A discussion of ongoing work and any challenges faced during the month.
4. **Future Plans:** The team outlines the next steps and upcoming tasks.

While the entire team's attendance is not mandatory, it is strongly encouraged to ensure full alignment and collective understanding of the project's status and direction.

Formalities:

- Monthly Heartbeat Report - for the management (and the client)
- Monthly Heartbeat Presentation - for the management (and the client)
- Monthly Heartbeat Meeting - with the Shipper for the management (and the client)
- Meeting Minutes - for the management (and the client)

Project Conclusion [E]

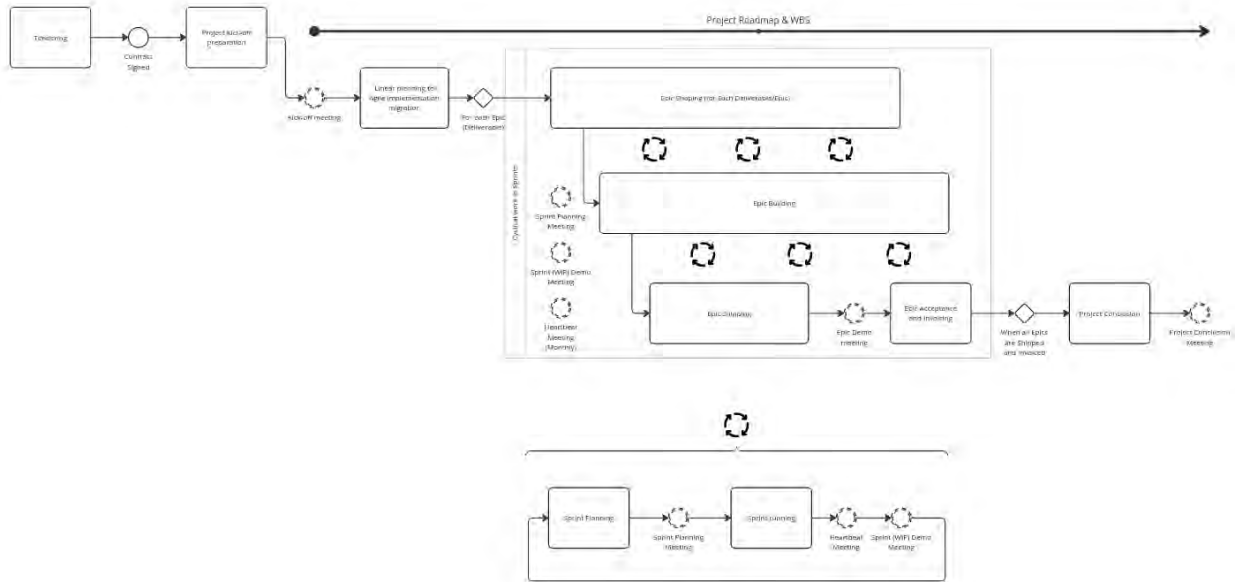
Formalities

- Conclusion meeting
- meeting presentation

- meeting minutes
- email to the client (and management) with the meeting minutes and the presentation

BPMN: Visualizing Our Workflow

To complement the detailed descriptions provided in this section, we've created a **Business Process Model and Notation (BPMN) diagram** to illustrate the complete end-to-end process of how projects are initiated, executed, and delivered at Meaningfy. This diagram serves as a concise visual guide for employees to follow along as they navigate the intricacies of our workflow.



Why Use This Diagram?

1. **Simplify Complexity:** Provides a clear and intuitive overview of the process described in words.
2. **Quick Reference:** Acts as a handy guide for employees to understand how their tasks fit into the larger project lifecycle.
3. **Alignment:** Ensures all employees are aligned with the same process structure and expectations.

Key Elements of the Diagram

The BPMN diagram highlights the major phases and their interdependencies:

1. **Project Conception:**
 - Creation of the Project Charter (PC) and Work Breakdown Structure (WBS).
 - Alignment of requirements with stakeholders.
2. **Work Shaping:**
 - Refinement of deliverables into Epics, Stories, and Tasks.
 - Allocation of resources and setting expectations for execution.
3. **Project Execution:**
 - Iterative cycles (Sprints) for incremental progress.
 - Regular rituals like Stand-Ups, Sprint Planning, and Demos.
4. **Shipping Phase:**
 - Final review, delivery, and client handover.
 - Quality assurance and reporting.
5. **Customer Success and Feedback:**

- Ongoing engagement with clients to ensure satisfaction and gather insights.

How to Use the Diagram

- **Follow Along:** Refer to the diagram as you read through the full workflow description. It provides a visual representation of the steps and their connections.
- **Understand Dependencies:** The diagram shows the flow from one phase to another, ensuring you grasp the bigger picture of project execution.
- **Refer Back Often:** Keep it handy during your work to ensure you stay aligned with Meaningfy's processes and best practices.

Documentation Standards

At Meaningfy, clear and consistent documentation is essential for our collaboration and success. While this handbook provides an overview, detailed best practices can be found in the Arts for Craftsmen guide on Confluence (<https://meaningfy.atlassian.net/wiki/x/MoAPfw>). This includes standards for README files, meeting minutes, and technical notes.

Expectations for Employees

1. Clarity and Accuracy:
 - All documentation must be concise, accurate, and kept up-to-date.
 - Regularly review and update existing documentation to reflect changes in processes or projects.
2. Using Confluence:
 - Log all project updates, decisions, and meeting notes in Confluence.
 - Ensure documentation is easily accessible and organized within the appropriate project space.
3. Templates and Standards:
 - Access all standard document templates in the [Meaningfy Templates folder](#) on Google Drive.
 - Use Meaningfy standard templates for README files, technical handovers, and meeting minutes.
 - For technical documentation, follow the guidelines outlined in the Arts for Craftsmen guide.

Naming Conventions

To ensure consistency and easy tracking, use this naming convention for all files and documents:

{Date} {Client-Order-Number} {Jira-key} {Document-Type} {Title}

- Date: Use ISO format YYYY-MM-DD.
- Client-Order-Number: A client-unique identifier for the project (e.g., 76129).
- Jira-key: The JIRA project key/identifier (e.g., EPO18).
- Document-Type: Abbreviated document type (e.g., MM for Meeting Minutes, PPT for PowerPoint).
- Title: Brief description of the document's content.

Example: 2025-11-24 [EPO18] 76129 MM Monthly Meeting

Header and Footer

All released documents shall include a header and a footer.

The header shall contain the document title, release date, and release version.

The footer shall contain the page number and the total number of pages.

For layout or stylistic reasons, the required information may be placed interchangeably in the header or footer, provided that all required information is present and clearly visible on each page.

Any released document shall be provided in PDF format.

If the native (editable) format is also required, it shall be shared together with the corresponding PDF version.

Role structure

On Roles, Profiles and Levels

At Meaningfy we distinguish between Roles and Profiles. Each Profile can have five levels described in the section on making a career.

Profiles are defined in terms of skills, competencies and academic background that a person has. We hire the following profiles:

- Semantic Engineer
- Software Engineer
- DevOps Engineer
- QA Engineer

Roles are defined in terms of responsibilities in the company or a project. Most often we refer to project roles (real-world equivalents in parentheses):

- Mastermind Wizard (Business Developer)
- Shaper (Project Owner)
- Builder (Engineering or Implementation Lead)
- Shipper (Delivery Manager)
- Quality Overseer (QA Lead)
- Customer Success Manager (Client Relationship Manager)

The company roles are:

- CEO
- Operations Officer
- Finance Officer
- Communications and Marketing Officer
- Business Development and Sales Officer

Brief: what are the project roles?

Business Developer - the Mastermind Wizard

The primary objective of this role is to identify and create business opportunities, utilising strategic insight and innovative approaches to drive commercial growth and expansion.

Key Responsibilities and Deliverables:

- Identifying market leads and converting them into profitable opportunities.
- Building and maintaining effective relationships with clients and stakeholders.
- Analysing the customer needs to guide business development.
- Develop a clear, and comprehensive project offer for the client that delimits clearly the scope, deadlines, and the approach.

Duration of Role: In a project, this role is exercised in the conception phase. In the company, this role is ongoing, with a focus on long-term strategic development within the business.

Reporting Structure: The Business Developer will report directly to the CEO and will engage closely with marketing, sales, and product development teams.

Project Owner - the Work Shaper

The Project Owner is responsible for shaping and guiding the project from its initial concept to successful completion. This role involves converting abstract ideas into practical, executable project plans, ensuring alignment with the client's vision and project objectives.

Key Responsibilities and Deliverables:

- Developing the Work Breakdown Structure based on the request for offer, the offer and adjacent meeting notes with the client.
- Establishing a project roadmap outlining key milestones, deliverables, and timelines.
- Writing down the Epic Pitches based on the Shape Up methodology, encompassing important aspects of planning and execution and detailing the scope, challenges, and resources needs.
- Identifying potential risks and formulating strategies to mitigate them.
- Overseeing and providing clear guidance and direction from project inception to delivery, ensuring all phases are well-defined and executed.
- Discover work (as more work is getting done) with the project Builders and map the Epic scope with User Stories (or Tasks).

Duration of Role: Although not full-time, this role is pivotal throughout the project lifecycle, from initial concept development to the final delivery of the project.

Reporting Structure: The Project Owner will report directly to the CEO, ensuring alignment with strategic goals and client requirements.

Builder - the Craftsman

The project Builder is responsible for the practical execution of project tasks, translating shaped conceptual designs into tangible, demonstrable and deliverable outcomes.

Key Responsibilities and Deliverables:

- Bridging the gap between conceptual plans and actual implementation, ensuring alignment with project specifications.
- Follow the Meaningfully-established and project-established methodologies and practices, and adapting, when necessary, skills and techniques to meet the evolving needs of the project.
- Collaborating with other project team members to ensure seamless integration of different components.
- Establishing, prior to starting a task, who will be the reviewer of the work done, and when that review will take place.
- Discovering work to be done as the work is progressively executed and reporting it to the Project Owner so that he/she can place in the Epic scope as User Stories (or Tasks).
- Documenting the development process, the technical decisions, architecture diagrams.
- Showing progress on Hill Charts (associated to an Epic).
- Demonstrating the work outcome at the end of the building phase as an internal shipping.

For Software Engineers

- Developing and refining software, meticulously crafting each feature and functionality.
 - Apply TDD, DDD and Onion Architecture.

For Semantic Engineers

- Constructing and evolving knowledge frameworks, ensuring they are comprehensive and accurate.
 - Apply LOT Methodology

Duration of Role: The duration is contingent upon the project lifecycle, focusing on the active building phase.

Reporting Structure: Reports to the Project Owner and Delivery Manager, depending on the project's nature.

Reviewer - the Quality Overseer

The Reviewer is primarily focused on evaluating the work outcomes of colleagues during the Building phase. Their responsibility is to ensure that these outcomes align with the project specifications, methodologies, and best practices.

Key Responsibilities and Deliverables

- Aligning with the Builder on what work needs to be reviewed by when.
- Actively engaging in the 'four eyes principle', where each piece of work is reviewed by another qualified team member to ensure compliance with Epic Pitch project specifications, quality standards, methodologies and best practices.
- Providing constructive feedback to colleagues to enhance quality and adherence to project guidelines.
- Documenting the review process and outcomes, and recommending improvements as necessary.

Duration of Role: This role is non-permanent but contextual based on the work done by the team. It is crucial throughout the Building phase of the project.

Reporting Structure: The Reviewer reports to the Project Owner and Delivery owner.

Delivery Manager - the Shipper

The Delivery Manager is responsible for overseeing the final phase of the project, ensuring the timely and accurate delivery of project outputs to the client. This role involves ensuring that all deliverables meet the highest quality standards and are in complete accordance with the contractual agreements.

Key Responsibilities and Deliverables:

- Managing the delivery process, steering the project outputs to the client efficiently and effectively.
- Conducting comprehensive inspections of the deliverables to guarantee quality and adherence to contract specifications.
- Overseeing logistics and delivery operations, ensuring safe and punctual handover of products or services.
- Facilitating a seamless handover process, achieving full client satisfaction and contractual compliance.

Duration of Role: The role is critical during the Shipping Phase of the project, focusing on the successful culmination and delivery of project outcomes.

Reporting Structure: The Delivery Manager reports to the Project Owner and Business Developer, coordinating with client representatives and internal teams during the delivery phase.

Customer Success Manager - the Wizard of Client Satisfaction

The Customer Success Manager is dedicated to maintaining and enhancing customer relationships. This role is pivotal in ensuring clients are not only satisfied with the deliverables, but also engaged and content with the overall service experience.

Key Responsibilities and Deliverables:

- Managing client relationships and the expectations, and ensuring high levels of customer satisfaction.
- Leading client meetings for project status updates or delivery demonstrations, with a focus on informing the client and building lasting goodwill engagement.
- Overseeing the client aftercare process, ensuring a smooth and satisfactory client journey post-delivery.
- Conducting thorough reviews and feedback sessions with clients to gauge satisfaction and gather insights for improvement.
- Facilitating the transition of project deliverables to clients, ensuring a ceremonial and satisfactory handover.

Duration of Role: This role is intermittent and continuous, with a focus on long-term customer relationship management and success.

Reporting Structure: The Customer Success Manager reports to the Project Owner and Business Developer, working closely with project teams during the Shipping Phase to ensure seamless client transitions and satisfaction.

Allegory: what are the project roles?

Business Developer - the Mastermind Wizard

A mystical strategist, conjuring opportunities and weaving spells of commerce.

- Merchant Magician
A sorcerer of trade, turning market leads into golden opportunities with a flick of their magic wand.
- Conjurer of Commerce
An alchemist of business, transforming base ideas into the gold of new ventures.
- Sage of Salesmanship
A wise figure, charting paths through the market maze with the insight of a seasoned oracle.



Project Owner - the Work Shaper

A sculptor of projects, moulding the raw clay of ideas into the fine statuary of finished products.

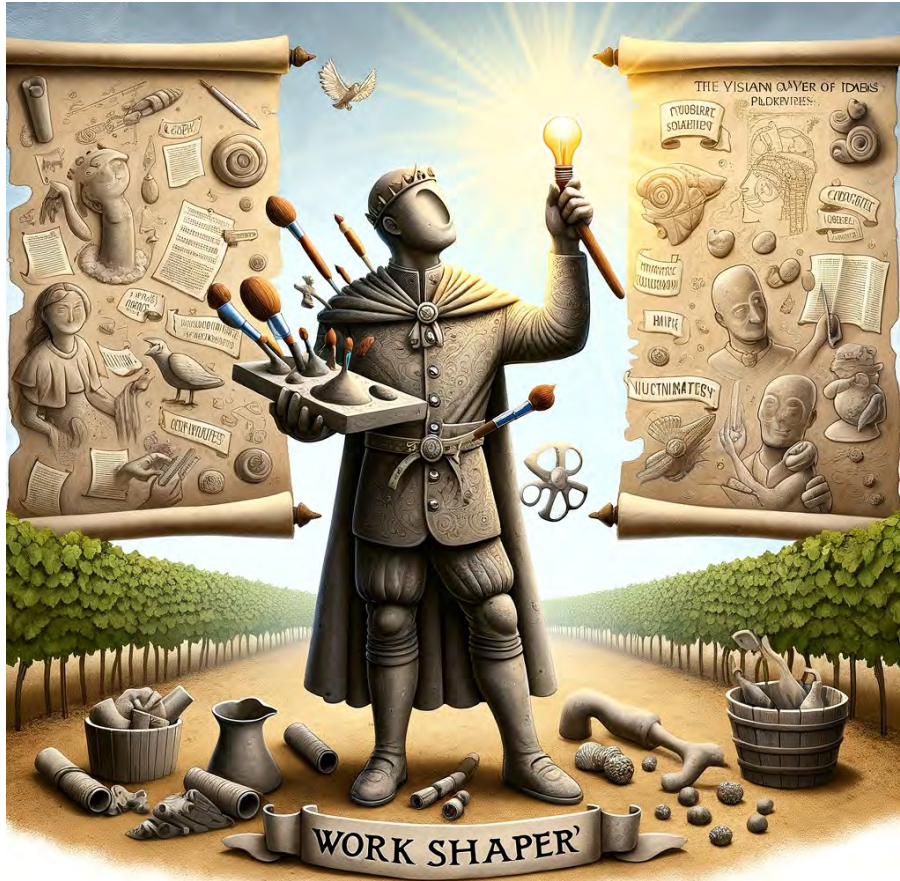
- Blueprint Baron
A noble of planning, drafting the scrolls that guide the artisans in their quest for creation.

- Idea Illuminator

A beacon of guidance, shining light on the path from conception to creation, ensuring every detail is as planned as a royal banquet.

- Visionary Vintner

A master of the craft, carefully cultivating the vineyard of ideas to produce the finest vintage of products.



Builder - the Craftsman

Carpenter, Mason, Tailor, Jeweller, Apothecary, Armourer, Bowyer, Shoemaker, Blacksmith, Artisan, Craftsman: The hands that shape dreams into reality, as versatile as a bard's repertoire.

- Guildmaster of Gears

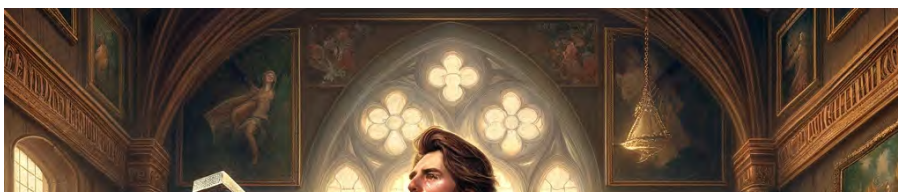
An all-rounder in the guild of creation, whether forging code, carving designs, or scripting tales.

- Architect of Artistry

A polymath of production, bridging the gap between concept and creation with the skill of a master mason.

- Chisel of Change

A chameleon in the workshop, adapting their tools and talents to whatever the project demands.





Software Engineer - the Scribe of Code Scrolls

Like a meticulous monk in a digital monastery, this scribe crafts scrolls of code, each line a testament to their devotion to quality and functionality, following the sacred rites of test-driven development.

Artisan of the Algorithmic Tapestry:

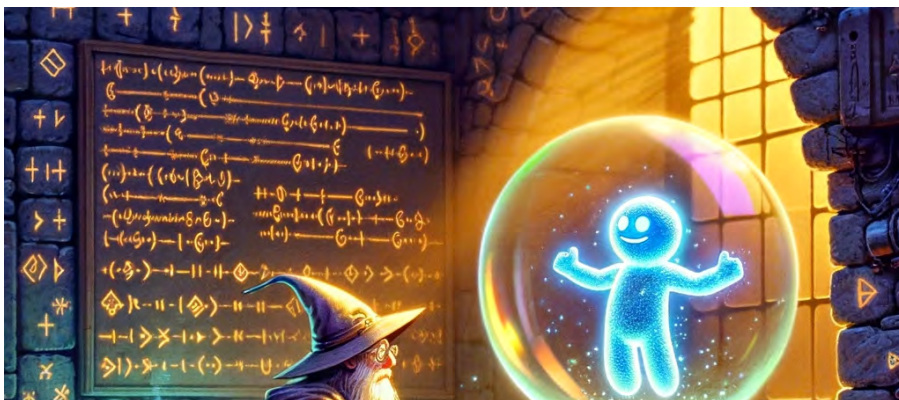
- With the deft hands of an ancient weaver, this artisan intertwines the threads of logic and function, creating tapestries of code that depict majestic tales of requirements and specifications, all while ensuring the fidelity of each stitch through rigorous testing.

Architect of the Digital Labyrinth

- Much like a master builder of yore, this architect designs the intricate labyrinths of software, mapping out the pathways of code with the precision of a domain-driven designer, ensuring that every corridor and chamber performs its duty as foretold by the blueprint of unit tests.

Maestro of the Silicon Symphony

- A conductor of a grand orchestra, this maestro composes symphonies of software, each note a line of code, each movement a function, harmoniously orchestrated to bring to life the visions dictated by the specifications, under the watchful eye of their fellow engineering virtuoso.





Semantic Engineer - the Architect of the Cosmic Codex

A grand title for one who designs universes of knowledge, complete with their own mystical rules and inhabitants, all interconnected in a cosmic dance of meaning and understanding.

Oracle of Ontological Realms

- Like a seer gazing into the mists of knowledge, this oracle charts the unseen universes of information, each with its own lore and logic. Their visions become the maps that guide the scholarly expeditions to the lands of shared understanding.

Sage of Semantic Symbology

- In the grand library of the mind, this sage inscribes the runes of meaning, weaving together the tapestry of concepts that cloak the naked truths of their domain, creating a symphony of interconnected ideas that resonate through the halls of academia and industry alike.

Guardian of the Grimoire of Knowledge

- A keeper of the sacred texts, this guardian curates the grimoires where concepts intertwine like ancient vines, each leaf a page of understanding, nurtured and pruned through the collective wisdom of the community's sages.





Reviewer - the Quality Overseer

The vigilant guardian of standards! Like a royal jeweller inspecting a gem for the czar, this inspector scrutinizes every facet of our project, ensuring that each piece sparkles with excellence and meets the highest decree of quality, aligning with profession methodologies, best practices and processes.

Custodian of the Craft:

- The one who safeguards the artistry of our creation. They ensure every detail, like a throne for the king, aligns with the grand design, preserving the sanctity of our work.

Overseer of Workmanship:

- A vigilant sentinel, ensuring our project's fortress stands strong and true. They uphold the excellence of our endeavour, ensuring our creation withstands the test of time and admiration.



Delivery Manager - the Shipper

The vigilant sentinel of the shipping process, not only steering the project caravan to the client's keep but also ensuring every parcel bears the seal of utmost quality and contract fidelity.

Caravan Commander

- This seasoned navigator of trade routes not only delivers goods but also inspects them with the eagle-eyed vigilance of a castle guard.

Herald of Handover

- More than a mere messenger, this herald ensures every delivery shines brighter than a troubadour's tale and aligns perfectly with the sacred scrolls of our agreements.

Custodian of Carriages

- A meticulous overseer of logistics, guarding the quality and contract fidelity of our creations as if they were crown jewels.



Customer Success Manager - the Wizard of Client Satisfaction

The bard(minstrel) of customer relations, singing the praises of our work and enchanting clients with service.

- Enchanter of Engagement
 - A magician of meetings, casting spells of satisfaction and weaving wands of goodwill.
- Ambassador of Aftercare
 - A diplomat of delivery, ensuring the client's journey is as smooth as a troubadour's tune.

• Sovereign of Success

A regal figure in the realm of relations, ruling with a sceptre of service and a crown of client contentment.



Allegory: Company roles

CEO - the Architect of Alliances and Voyager of Ventures

- A strategic builder of bridges, crafting alliances and partnerships that fortify our company's position in the realm of commerce.
- Like a daring explorer, this role sets sail on the high seas of business, charting new territories and forging lucrative paths.



Head of Operations - the Master of Mechanisms and Custodian of the Keep

- This role orchestrates the intricate cogs and wheels of our company, ensuring everything runs as smoothly as a well-oiled catapult.
- Guardian of the day-to-day stronghold, ensuring our company fortress stands firm against the winds of market change.



Marketing specialist - the Bard of the Castle and Sorcerer of Sentiments

- The minstrel who sings the saga of our brand, charming the masses with tales of our wares.
- A magical maestro who conjures emotions and desires through enchanting campaigns, casting a spell on the market.



Onboarding

Welcome to Meaningfy

Prior to or during your first week of employment, we will conduct a comprehensive general onboarding session to ensure a smooth transition into our 100% remote IT company. This session is designed to reduce the learning curve and help you understand how our company operates. We will ensure that you have access to all necessary software and tools, setting up your digital workspace to match our operational standards. Additionally, we will provide an orientation tour of our virtual office, familiarizing you with our online communication platforms, project management systems, timesheets and key resources. This onboarding will equip you with everything you need to start your journey with us confidently and efficiently.

Role-Specific Onboarding

Following the general onboarding, we will provide a role-specific onboarding tailored to your particular responsibilities within the company. This phase will be conducted by a fellow employee who is already in a similar role, ensuring that you receive practical, hands-on guidance from someone with relevant experience. This targeted onboarding will delve into the specific tools, processes, and expectations associated with your position, helping you to integrate seamlessly into your team and excel in your role.

Getting started

Before You Start

Before the General Onboarding session, you will be granted access to the following accounts:

- **Google Workspace** (your Meaningfy email account)
- **Atlassian** (linked to your Meaningfy email)
- **Slack** (linked to your Meaningfy email)
- **Airtable** (linked to your Meaningfy email)
- **Meaningfy Intranet** (linked to your Meaningfy email)

Make sure to check your email for access credentials and follow the setup instructions provided.

General Onboarding

In your first week, we'll guide you through a **General Onboarding Session** designed to help you understand how our 100% remote IT company operates. Here's what to expect:

- **Access to Tools and Resources:** We'll ensure your digital workspace is ready with all the tools and platforms you need.
- **Introduction to Our Culture and Values:** You'll learn about Meaningfy's mission, vision, and principles that guide how we work together.
- **Virtual Office Orientation:** We'll show you around our online communication platforms (like Slack), project management systems (like Jira), timesheets, and key resources.
- **Q&A Session:** Get answers to any initial questions you have about processes, tools, or team dynamics.
- **Recorded Screenscasts:** When available, you'll receive pre-recorded walkthroughs of key onboarding topics; while not all sessions may yet be recorded, we're continually expanding our library so that you—and future hires—can ramp up without always needing live calls.

This session is your first step to a confident and efficient start with us.

Role-Specific Onboarding

After the General Onboarding, you'll move into a **Role-Specific Onboarding phase**, where you'll:

- Work closely with a **Buddy**: A fellow employee in a similar role will guide you through the day-to-day tools, processes, and expectations.
- Dive into Tools and Responsibilities: You'll receive detailed training on the specific tools and workflows used in your role.
- Settle Into Your Team: Understand your role within the team and how your contributions align with our goals.

Your Buddy will be your go-to person for any questions during your first weeks, ensuring you feel supported and confident.

Checklist for Onboarding

To keep track of your progress, we've created a **Checklist** personalised to you and your role. This includes:

- Tasks to complete during your onboarding journey.
- Links to training resources, documentation, and guides.
- Key milestones to achieve in your first 30, 60, and 90 days.

Feel free to ask your Buddy or Manager for help if you have questions about any of the tasks.

Feedback and Support

We care about your onboarding experience. After your first month, you'll have the opportunity to provide feedback on the process. This helps us improve and ensure future employees have an even better experience.

Remember, your Buddy and Manager are always here to support you, so don't hesitate to reach out!

Work environment

1. Operating system & platform preferences

At Meaningfy we **standardise on Linux** because our CI pipelines, container images and internal scripts target that environment. We recommend a recent **LTS** release (Ubuntu 22.04 LTS, Linux Mint 21 LTS) or a **well-supported rolling distro** (EndeavourOS, Fedora Silverblue).

- **Install Linux from day one** (native, dual-boot, or a VM/WSL2 image).
- If you must start on Windows + WSL or macOS, that is acceptable **provided you resolve platform-specific issues independently**.
- Should the same OS-related problem block delivery more than once, you may be asked to migrate fully to Linux in your own time.

Why so strict?

Mixed OS setups create hidden discrepancies (different CLI tools, case-sensitive paths, Docker quirks). A common platform keeps “works on my machine” incidents—and support overhead—near zero.

2. Intranet – the single source of truth

<http://intranet.meaningfy.ws>

Our intranet aggregates everything that matters:

- **Vacation requests** – submit, track approval, see team availability.
- **Timesheets** – export for invoicing.
- **Project dashboards** – shippers update budget burn-down, milestone status and risks; everyone sees the same data.

All entries are synchronised from—and to—Airtable, so numbers stay consistent across tools.

3. General-purpose tools (Google Workspace)

Email – Your @meaningfy address is your digital ID; use it only for external stakeholders (clients / vendors). Internal conversations stay on Slack.

Drive – Store contracts, decks, spreadsheets. Project folders follow the convention: <client>_<project>_<yyyy> and are curated by the Team Shaper.

Calendar – Events originate in Airtable, propagate automatically to Google Calendar. Use Calendar only to invite attendees; do not store private notes there.

4. Communication & Collaboration

Slack is our real-time backbone.

- Project channels: one per project (e.g. #proj-client-xyz).
- #general: company-wide announcements, daily stand-ups and town-halls.
- #aligning: people/management topics and onsite events.
- #learning: training links and technical papers.
- #random: social chat, memes, weekend photos.
- Technical feeds: #dev-info, #task-info, #swarmia-kpi.

Etiquette

Reply in threads, use @channel sparingly (major releases or blockers), use @here only for production emergencies, and schedule meetings if a huddle will exceed fifteen minutes.

Confluence – project & knowledge wiki

Each project or programme has its own Space with four core pages:

1. *Impact filter* (purpose and success criteria)
2. *Meeting minutes*
3. *Requirements* (business needs and work shapes)
4. *Technical documentation* (diagrams, decisions, hand-over notes).

The Team Shaper keeps structure tidy; everyone contributes. Company-wide Spaces include *Meaningfy*, *Communication* and *Business Development*. production emergencies).

5. Project & knowledge management

Jira – canonical backlog and sprint board. Log time, move tickets, and present progress via **Hill Charts**.

<https://meaningfy.atlassian.net/jira/projects>

Confluence – every project has a space for pitches, requirements, meeting minutes and technical decisions.

<https://meaningfy.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces>

SmartSheet – client-facing Gantt charts that mirror Jira epics and contractual milestones.

6. Monitoring & operations – Airtable

<https://airtable.com/appC1oe54...>

- **KPIs** – individual velocity, project margin, client NPS.
 - **Vacations & timesheets** – master record that feeds invoicing.
 - **Forecast & finance** – quarterly pipeline, cash-flow, ARR.
-

7. Code & delivery infrastructure

GitHub – mono-repos and micro-repos; GitHub Actions run tests, build Docker images and push artefacts.

Zoho Invoice – generates PDF invoices from approved timesheets; recommended but not mandatory if you already use another compliant software.

8. Role-specific toolkits

Software developers

- **PyCharm Professional** (licence provided) or any IDE that supports remote interpreters, Docker and Python linters.
- Adhere to black + ruff formatting; commit hooks shipped in each repo.

Semantic engineers

- **Enterprise Architect** + **model2owl** for UML-to-OWL pipelines.
- **VocBench** for vocabulary curation.
- Paid platforms (TopBraid EDG, PoolParty) can be adopted if ROI is justified – align with your manager first.

DevOps / SRE

- **Hetzner Cloud** for VMs, DNS and S3-compatible storage.
 - **GoDaddy / EuroDNS** for domain registration and delegation.
 - **Wordpress & Divi** for website development
 - Terraform modules live in `infra/` within each repo; state stored in remote backend.
-
-

One OS, one intranet, one communication lane, and a curated toolchain keep our fully-remote team predictable, auditable and fast. Stick to the defaults—deviate only with a clear business reason.

Use of Company Email

To maintain security, professionalism, and consistency, all employees must use their **Meaningfy company email account** for work-related activities and identification. Your company email is your official identifier within Meaningfy and for all external communications.

Guidelines for Using Company Email:

- **Use your @meaningfy.com** address for all external and internal work-related communications (clients, vendors, audits, Git operations, etc.).
GitHub commits: set your official Meaningfy email in Git config (`git config --global user.email "firstname.lastname@meaningfy.com"`) so that contributions are properly attributed. If you maintain separate open-source projects
- and prefer not to expose your corporate email, you may add your @meaningfy.com address as a secondary GitHub email but commit with your personal address on those repos.
- **Systems access:** your Meaningfy email is the only credential for company tools, platforms, and single sign-on flows.
- **Personal email:** never use a personal address for any project-related accounts, tickets, or document sharing—except for the GitHub exception above.

Making a career

Your First Year

Congratulations! You're part of the team!

In your first few weeks, you'll get aligned with your manager and team on approach and expectations. You'll get up and running, doing real work.

It's your manager's responsibility to give you proper opportunities to demonstrate your skills and suitability for the job. This includes your technical expertise, your engagement with coworkers, and your ability to take feedback and adapt to the Meaningfy culture. Similarly, it's on you to take advantage of those opportunities and to show that you're capable of meeting the team standards.

When you start, you'll receive an outline of expected performance metrics. Those standards will be clear and attainable, and your manager will give you frequent, candid feedback on how you're doing meeting them, as you go.

You'll have formal performance reviews with your manager at the 3-, 6-, and 12-month marks. On occasion, despite our collective best efforts, the role may not be the right fit. We don't initiate full-scale performance improvement plans during the first year. So, if during that time it starts looking like your long-term employment won't work out, your manager will let you know early — and explain why.

By the time you've reached your 1st anniversary with the company, we expect to be as excited about working with you as we were on day one. Likewise, you should consider if you feel the same about having joined the team. When both of those answers are "hell yeah!", you'll move into a less frequent performance review cycle. Just twice a year, around your anniversary of joining the company and six months after that.

Your first year with Meaningfy should confirm what we learned in the hiring phase — you're well suited for this job, and you're invigorated by the work to be done. Just put in your best effort, make sure you reach out if things aren't feeling right, embrace the feedback you get from your manager, and openly share your feedback with them!

Mastery & Levels

Advancing your career at Meaningfy doesn't mean giving up on your craft. No matter your role, you can become better at the work itself and level up that way. This is especially important since we're a small company with nearly no layers of managerial cake.

Within each of our job functions, we've mapped our trajectory of mastery to five different levels. That title structure is shared amongst all departments, but the particulars of what characterizes one level from another will of course be different.

- Junior (L1)
- Mid-level (L2)
- Senior (L3)
- Lead (L4)
- Principal (L5)

Mastery and internal leveling are assessed and determined during hiring.

If you're hired at a level below Senior, you should work towards developing Senior level skills. Juniors should achieve Senior in 4 years (2 to Mid-level, 2 to Senior), and Mid-level contributors should achieve Senior in 2 years. When everyone is able to follow that trajectory, we create healthy, high-performing teams where everyone can trust each other to run at similar speeds. When

people aren't able to level up within the above timeframes, after ample opportunities to do so, we usually determine that to be a bad long-term fit, and we'll decide to part ways.

Once you reach Senior, to progress further, you need to contribute with innovative work that creates a resounding impact across the organisation and even the industry. Those who do end up progressing all the way through our path usually have worked at Meaningfy for about a decade or more.

Pay & Promotions

The payment rates in Meaningfy are negotiated individually with each person on hiring. We factor in the market rates, the residence location, the level of skill, and position in Meaningfy.

When you get a promotion, that is you move from one level to another, you'll get a corresponding pay raise effective on your next pay cycle.

Performance Reviews

You'll meet with your manager for formal performance reviews. When you're new to Meaningfy, you'll meet at the 3-month, 6-month, and 1-year marks.

Then you'll meet twice a year, around your anniversary with the company and six months after. Your manager will share performance expectations for your role when you start, and they'll keep you apprised of any changes to expectations should they evolve.

Managers are expected to document performance review outcomes and any action items or deadlines that come out of the meetings.

Performance Improvement Plans (PIP)

If your work performance is not meeting expectations, you may be put on a PIP. We only initiate PIPs if your manager's concern is correctable in the short term (less than 3 months). We do NOT initiate PIPs for fundamental performance issues that relate to your core job skills.

For example, if you're a programmer whose coding skills are not at the level they need to be, we'd forego a PIP. However, we may initiate a PIP to help you improve your performance in a coachable skill like project management.

Software Engineer Profile

Programming Management

On Web and Backend programming teams, Lead Programmers (L4) and Principal Programmers (L5) act as tech leads to Junior - Senior Programmers (L1-3). All Leads and Principals report directly to our CTO. Tech leads are responsible for:

- Reviewing a report's substantial PRs before they're shipped.
- Having a kick-off conversation with a report on every substantial project.
- Reviewing a report's on-call work and handoff after every shift.
- Providing People Ops with the key input to annual performance reviews.
- Identifying and escalating slips in performance or process to People Ops.
- A tech lead on the SIP team also acts as SIP Coordinator. They're responsible for setting cycle priorities, liaising with other project teams, and maintaining general oversight of team resources.

Tools: Python Debugger, PyTest, Make, pip & poetry, SonarCube, GitHub actions, Kibana, Postman

Frameworks: FastAPI, rdflib, pandas, Dash

Individual Contributor Expectations

Category/Level	Junior Programmer (L1)	Programmer (L2)	Senior Programmer (L3)	Lead Programmer (L4)	Principal Programmer (L5)
Skill					
<i>Mastery</i>	Proficient in basic language and framework features, but some advanced structures or features may still be unfamiliar. Occasional issues following patterns and approaches within existing code bases.	Follows established patterns and approaches within existing code bases with ease. Writes code that is considered high quality by colleagues. Effectively and artfully applies domain design skills in normal course of work.	Capable of devising new patterns and conventions within existing code bases and in greenfield development. Code remains accurate, reliable, and maintainable even when faced with challenging or complicated problems.	Acts as a subject matter expert on multiple systems. Makes strategic decisions around major components.	Invents new concepts, creates new systems, pushes the whole organization or industry forward regularly.
<i>Scope</i>	Capable of working on tightly-scoped, routine problems.	Capable of working on clearly defined and scoped individual features or problems.	Capable of taking substantial features from concept to shipping as the sole programmer (with a complementary developer on the side, e. g. if UI then backend, if backend then UI).	Capable of owning and running entire subsystems of work (Make expert, GitHub Actions/Jenkins implementation). Strong track record of introducing significant improvements in system quality, performance, or scalability.	Can set the strategic direction of an entire discipline, such as security, web or mobile. Consistently works on projects with high complexity. Would be the go-to person for advice on the most technically challenging problems.

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<i>Judgment</i>	Demonstrates curiosity in their craft, prioritizes their own development to better serve their team. Researches what's been done in the past and why, attempts to solve problems independently.	Proactively identifies and resolves problems, improves areas of the code they work on, and leaves things in better shape than they found them. Pays attention to detail.	Has accumulated sufficient experience to be consistently sought by peers, across multiple teams, for advice. Improves existing professional standards for the team.	Has the experience, trust and respect to operate at the tech lead level. Defines professional standards. Is sought for advice across disciplines.	Is seen as a leader across teams, technically and culturally. Capable of setting and directing across an entire discipline, such as Backend, Web or Mobile. Is known company-wide as a go-to expert for advice on critical work across disciplines.
<i>Tooling</i>	Has a rudimentary understanding of our tools and open standards (RDF, OWL, SPARQL, SHACL).	Uses our most common tools in day to day work to help diagnose issues (debugging, code linting, automated code testing, SonarQube-like etc.), optimise performance (of the code and of yourself).	Demonstrates a comprehensive understanding of all our tools. Uses them regularly to diagnose issues quickly and calmly, even under pressure.	An expert in our tools. Extends and improves them over time. Can identify where tooling should be improved and oversee implementation.	Invents novel tools with strategic impact. Can objectively rationalise whether to build or buy, balancing tradeoffs with business strategy in mind.
Engagement					
<i>Ownership - Manager of One</i>	Participates in programmer on-call rotation under guidance from more senior programmer. Delivers simple resolutions end-to-end.	Participates in programmer on-call shifts with guidance from a more senior team member. Capable of handling or triaging production issues across multiple systems with minimal assistance. Can be relied upon to lead the resolution of bugs or minor incidents related to their work or area of expertise.	Can proactively recognize and raise major incidents and lead the response from inception to resolution.	Can lead the resolution of any engineering problem in their discipline. Is a significant technical contributor to problem resolution; demonstrates consistent maturity in communication and demeanor under stress.	Fully capable of leading the most critical production incidents to successful resolution, coordinating company-wide responses and advising on public communications.
<i>Communication</i>	Proactively communicates what they are working on, attempts to unblock themselves but asks for help when needed. Questions mostly don't repeat.	Presents pull requests that demonstrates competency with our patterns and principles, but may require oversight from senior peers. Questions to more senior coworkers are thoroughly researched and presented before posed.	Trusted to provide actionable feedback across team pull requests in line with our principles and conventions. Requires little or no oversight. Provides technical advice and suggestions during planning/scoping.	Provides critical, actionable feedback on pull requests which ensures quality and consistency is upheld across the team. Demonstrates project management best practices. Ensures leadership is informed on team progress. Writes Heartbeats and Kickoffs.	Demonstrates long-term strategic thinking, working with leadership to communicate our engineering vision across teams and disciplines.

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<i>Planning</i>	Prioritizes daily work against team/project needs with regular guidance. Demonstrates good time management.	Prioritizes tasks and project work with little direction. Works confidently and effectively, persists when faced with uncertainty or ambiguity, but pulls in support when needed. Identifies judo opportunities on demand (i.e. find creative ways of doing things more efficiently; how to fit an elephant into a fridge). Contributes more broadly to cycle planning within the team.	Requires no direction to effectively manage their time, finds valuable and productive tasks to work on without prodding, and helps steer cycle planning. Identifies judo opportunities in their own work and for others. Fosters collaboration across teams.	Can plan an entire or multiple cycles for a team. Can drive the agenda, hammer scope, offer critical insight from extensive experience. Regularly challenges their team or discipline to help drive projects forward, to better deliver on team/discipline priorities.	Capable of running and directing larger teams for multiple cycles, and for large, long-running projects. Elevates team and company standards through developing new tooling, processes, procedures, and highly effective communication. Carries out research, testing, implementation and improvement for new systems. Pushes the whole organization forward regularly through implementing new systems and designs.
<i>Trust</i>	Work is thoroughly reviewed with substantial back and forth frequently needed before merging. Reads pull requests. Makes minor contributions to the improvement of system documentation.	Work is reviewed with some back and forth and the occasional need for material direction or implementation changes. Trusted to review non-critical pull requests to clarify style, readability, performance issues. Makes material contributions to documentation: features, procedures, runbooks (guides), pitches.	Work doesn't necessarily need to be reviewed, but general approach may be. Trusted to review critical or full-batch pull requests, course-corrects when required. Provides context and clarity to the engineering organization by producing and maintaining documentation / runbooks / pitches.	Major projects can be completed independently and shipped without review. Provides developing oversight to senior, mid, and juniors. Expected to review complex and high-impact pull requests across teams. Defines and maintains departmental standards by developing processes and procedures, writing style guides, recording internal screencasts.	Entire systems can be designed, developed, and shipped without the need for review. Provides developing oversight to everyone else in organization. Expected to review system architecture across multiple product suites to oversee work is produced to the highest technical standards. A leader in ensuring robust and effective best practices are understood and followed across the engineering organization.
Coachability					
<i>Feedback</i>	Observes and learns from the work and behavior of others. Receives constructive feedback with a growth mindset.	Receives constructive feedback with a growth mindset. Provides specific, well-considered feedback within area of expertise, when asked. Is able to disagree and commit.	Can provide specific, material, constructive feedback on the work of other (junior-mid-senior) programmers that deepens their knowledge across broad areas. Is able to disagree and commit.	Is a formal mentor to programmers, providing specific, material, constructive feedback on work. Capable of being a technical lead on small teams. Consistently sought by colleagues for assistance with critical work or decisions. Is able to disagree and commit.	Is a formal mentor to programmers, providing specific, material, constructive feedback on work. Defines engineering-wide standards and guidance. Fully capable of leading teams of any size over an entire discipline. Consistently sought by colleagues across the organization for assistance with critical work or decisions. Is able to disagree and commit.

DevOps Engineer Profile

Site reliability engineering (SRE or DevOps) is the practice of using software tools to automate IT infrastructure tasks such as system management and application monitoring. Organizations use SRE to ensure their software applications remain reliable amidst frequent updates from development teams.

Areas: configuration management, containers, continuous integration / development, debugging, orchestration, optimization, networking, performance, reliability, security.

Category/Level	Junior SRE (L1)	SRE (L2)	Senior SRE (L3)	Lead SRE (L4)	Principal SRE (L5)
Skill					
<i>Mastery</i>	Competent in 1-2 areas (e.g. networking, configuration management, containers, orchestration) and with common processes and procedures.	Proficient in one or more areas of expertise (e.g. networking, configuration management, containers, orchestration), and experienced with common processes and procedures.	Proficient in multiple areas of expertise (e.g. networking, configuration management, containers, orchestration), and fully understands common processes and procedures.	Expert in multiple areas. Leads the team and mentors others on common processes and procedures.	Has multiple, broad areas of expertise: configuration management, containers, continuous integration / development, debugging, orchestration, optimization, networking, performance, reliability, security. Makes what is new normal; what is old reliable; evangelize what is next.
<i>Mastery</i>	Assists with performing work on production systems with help from more senior teammates. Performs low-risk maintenance with help.	Performs work on production systems by following existing procedures. Plans and performs low-risk maintenance independently.	Plans and performs maintenance independently. Participates in higher risk maintenances.	Performs complex work like capacity planning, load testing, and security improvements. Leads high-risk maintenance with limited to no customer impact.	Leads high-risk maintenance with limited to no customer impact. When a site is down, something is broken, or work is crazy, ready to save the day and lead us to a successful resolution.
<i>Mastery</i>	Shadows on call shifts and assists with triaging on-call issues.	Participates in on call shifts with the backing of a more senior team member. Confidently handles or triages production issues.	Full participant in regular on-call shifts and confident in ability to handle or triage production issues.	Can lead the resolution of any problem. Significant technical contributor to problem resolution; demonstrates consistent maturity in communication and demeanor under stress.	Fully capable of leading critical incident response. Coordinates internal and external responses to major issues. Leads problem resolution via emergency procedures.
<i>Tech and Tooling</i>	Uses our most common tools & systems in day to day work.	Familiar with all the major tools, systems, and documentation.	Subject matter expert in at least one of our major systems.	Subject matter expert on multiple systems. You help make strategic decisions around major components.	Leader on the team, technically and culturally. Manages critical, complex projects independently and capable of effectively delegating large subsections of work to your teammates. Spends considerable time helping others improve.

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<i>Scope</i>	Works independently on smaller projects. Shows strength in some areas of specialization, but lacks experience in all areas yet.	Works independently on small projects and is a reliable contributor to larger projects and resolving major problems. Shows strength in some areas of specialization, but lack experience in all areas yet.	Works independently on small projects and are a reliable contributor to larger projects and resolving major problems.	Elevates team and company standards through developing new tooling, processes, procedures, and effective communication. Carries out research, testing, implementation and improvement for new systems.	Elevates team and company standards through developing new tooling, processes, procedures, and effective communication. Carries out research, testing, implementation and improvement for new systems. You push the whole organization forward regularly through implementing new systems and designs.
<i>Judgment</i>	Manages projects with help scoping and planning. Demonstrates curiosity in their discipline and seeks out advice from more senior teammates.	Scopes and manages small projects with minimal oversight and approval. Has a good sense for when to cut scope to deliver projects on time. Identifies and resolves problems, improves work they touch/leaves work in better shape. Pays attention to detail.	Scopes and manages large projects with minimal assistance. Experience is sought by peers for advice. Improves existing professional standards for the team.	Strong ability to set scope and manage critical projects with minimal oversight or approval. Defines professional standards. Is sought out for advice.	Able to apply agility and judo to even the most complex of deep technical work. Ensures that team's output is at the highest technical standards. A leader in ensuring robust and effective best practices are understood and followed across the organization.
Engagement					
<i>Ownership - Manager of One</i>	Requires help setting a direction when assigned work. Asks questions when needs help, researches what's been done in the past and why, attempts to solve problems independently.	Set their own direction once assigned work. Asks questions but doesn't need regular status checks.	Sets their own direction and works with little to no oversight or help. Conceptualizes new work to be done, steps to get there, and then executes the steps to complete it.	Capable of setting team direction. Skillfully manages projects and resources, requiring little to no redirection or input from leadership.	Fully capable of leading the most critical production incidents to successful resolution, coordinating company-wide responses and advising on public communications.
<i>Communication</i>	Communicates well in team calls and check-ins, heartbeats, and kick-offs.	Attempts to unblock themselves but ask for help when needed. Communicates well within the team structure, sharing knowledge and bringing in more experienced teammates when needed.	Attempts to unblock themselves but ask for help when needed. Communicates well within the team structure, sharing knowledge and bringing in more experienced teammates when needed.	Acts as a representative to the company, weighing in on larger discussions and making recommendations. Rarely need help unblocking themselves, and acts as a resource for others.	Demonstrate project management and communication best practices. Ensures leadership is informed on team progress. Responsible for cycle planning.

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<i>Planning</i>	Plans individual tasks with little oversight. Can identify small pieces of work without having them assigned. Able to pitch small projects or improvements to the team and explain why it's important and should be prioritized.	Plans individual projects effectively with little oversight. Contributes to cycle planning. Identifies work without having it assigned and without asking others what's important. Able to pitch projects to the team and explain why it's important and should be prioritized.	Plans individual projects. Contributes to cycle planning. Identifies work without having it assigned and without asking others what's important. Able to pitch projects to the team and explain why it's important and should be prioritized.	Key contributor to cycle planning. Able to plan and execute large projects while keeping team and company strategy in mind.	Regularly challenges their team or discipline to help drive projects forward, to better deliver on team /discipline priorities.
<i>Flexibility</i>	Has some points of view about technical solutions and best practices, but mostly observes and learns from the more senior members of your team.	Demonstrated willingness to express a viewpoint and opinion, and able to disagree and commit.	Demonstrated strong points of view about technical approaches and solutions that are rooted in experience. Willing to express a viewpoint and opinion, and also able to disagree and commit.	Strong points of view rooted in experience, technical expertise, and industry best practices. Expresses opinions confidently and effectively, and can balance your recommendations with the larger needs of the team. Able to disagree and commit.	Demonstrated ability to think through problems and devise and apply novel solutions that are outside the box. Able to disagree and commit.
<i>Trust</i>	Contributes to small projects with direction and help. Work is reviewed.	Productive member of the team, able to contribute effectively to small projects. Work is reviewed with the occasional need for material direction or implementation changes.	Fully productive member of the team, able to contribute to almost any project. Work doesn't necessarily need to be reviewed, but general approach may be.	Able to contribute to any project. Work happens completely autonomously with no regular need for review. Work is almost always free of mistakes, and you often help others improve the quality of their work.	Significant technical contributor to complex problem resolution; demonstrates consistent maturity in communication and demeanor under stress.
Coachability					
<i>Feedback</i>	Actively seeks feedback. Receives feedback with a positive attitude, and applies corrective feedback. Hungry for growth & development.	Able to weigh in on larger discussions at the team level with helpful, relevant feedback. Receives feedback with a growth mindset.	Able to act as informal mentor, and provides helpful, direct, specific feedback to more junior teammates.	Capable of being a technical lead. Sought by colleagues on and off the team for help with critical work or decisions. Able to disagree and commit.	Capable of being a team lead to any size team. Sought by colleagues on and off the team for help with critical work or decisions. Able to disagree and commit.

QA Engineer Profile

Tools: browser dev tools, pytest, behave, gherkin

Category/Level	Senior QA Tester (L3)	Lead QA Tester (L4)
Skill		
<i>Mastery</i>	Demonstrates broad depth of knowledge of our products. Produces well-considered, high-quality QA reports beyond the happy path. Skilled in our entire testing toolset.	Intimate knowledge of our entire product suite. Acts as a subject matter expert on our QA approach, product features and shortcomings. Skilled in other testing disciplines such as accessibility, security or advanced tools (e.g. Litmus, Browser Stack, Test Rail)
<i>Scope</i>	Consistent demonstration of applying the right balance of QA based on the scope and criticality of new features. Can assume responsibility for coordinating the testing work of third- party vendors.	Defines our QA approach and sets the standard for the team. Oversees all product QA across a cycle, including coordination of third-party testing firms. Ensures product pairings are considering all types of risks, including Security, Performance, and Accessibility as well as functional during development. Actively levels up less-experienced QA testers.
<i>Technical</i>	Has a good understanding of our technical architecture as it relates to QA, providing technical insight when writing bug reports. Competence using browser dev tools, pytest, behave, gherkin. Runs apps locally, demonstrates good GitHub skills.	Broad understanding of our technical architecture across all platforms, as it relates to QA. Skilled in testing across multiple OSes: macOS, Windows, Linux, Android, iOS. Deep understanding of browser nuances and browser dev tools. Strong command of accessibility concerns and how these relate to CSS and Javascript.
<i>Judgment</i>	Proactively identifies QA problems, knows when to raise bugs on our issues board vs On Call, and when to raise an incident. Pays attention to detail and can demonstrate testing pragmatism.	Demonstrates strong cultural alignment with Meaningful doctrine when making decisions. Can identify judo opportunities during product development. Is consistently sought for advice across testing and accessibility disciplines. Proactively identifies issues relating to work quality of internal or external QA.
Engagement		
<i>Ownership - Manager of One</i>	Oversees feature QA end-to-end. Logs bugs and issues, provides assistance as fixes make it through to production.	Coaches other testers on the quality and testing approach for major projects and initiatives. Defines and upholds our QA standards. Maintains our 'Top 5' lists, preventing overpopulation. Works with product and engineering leadership to assist progress with delivering these fixes.

<i>Communication</i>	Writes high-quality bug reports. Trusted to provide well-written QA support and feedback throughout feature development. Provides feedback on the QA process, suggesting improvements in the interests of the company. Forges strong relationships with product programmers and designers.	Sets the standard for bug reporting. Defines QA standards, ensures they're upheld. Forges strong relationships with QA peers, and cross-department. Writes absorbing cycle Kickoffs and Heartbeats. Demonstrates project management best practices. Ensures leadership is kept informed, async, on QA progress. Celebrates team and individual achievements.
<i>Prioritization</i>	Balances inbound work, paying attention to schedules and ensuring the right projects are QA'd at the right time. Prioritizes tasks and project work with little direction, minimising QA blockers for dev pairings. Works confidently and effectively, persists when faced with uncertainty or ambiguity but pulls in support when needed. Contributes to planning within the QA team.	Is organised and efficient. Closely collaborates with Product to triage and prioritise resolution of bugs / quick wins. Can plan entire cycles for a team. Can offer critical product insight drawn from extensive experience. Regularly challenges their team and discipline to help drive projects forward, makes process improvements year on year.
<i>Trust</i>	Work is reviewed with some back and forth and the occasional need for material direction or implementation changes. Trusted to run QA end-to-end for product features that requires little or no oversight or correction. Makes material contributions to documentation.	Consistently sought by colleagues for assistance with QA, feature scope or issue severity decisions. Capable of directing the QA team strategy for an entire cycle. Oversees the work of third-party firms (testing, accessibility), providing feedback and ensuring appropriate quality.
Coachability		
<i>Feedback</i>	Receives constructive feedback with a growth mindset. Has self-awareness about core strengths and areas for development. Provides specific, well-considered feedback within area of expertise, when asked. Is able to disagree and commit.	Seeks constructive feedback on own work with a growth mindset. Has self-awareness about core strengths and areas for development. Provides developing oversight to senior, mid, and junior QA testers. Can disagree and commit.

Semantic Engineer (SE) Profile

Open standards: RDF, OWL/RDFS, SPARQL, SHACL, RML

Activities: Ontology development, Data mapping, FAIR data publishing

Principles: Test-Driven, Data-Centric, Clean Coder

Methodologies: LOT methodology, Mapping Methodology, Diataxis (for technical documentation writing)

Tools: Enterprise Architect, model2owl, AsciiDoc, Make, GitHub/Git, GoogleSheet

Category/Level	Junior SE (L1)	Intermediary SE (L2)	Senior SE (L3)	Lead SE (L4)	Principal SE (L5)
Skill					
<i>Mastery</i>	Proficient in basic open standards and adopted methodologies but some advanced features may still be unfamiliar. Occasional issues in following patterns and approaches within existing projects.	Follows established methodologies, patterns and approaches within existing projects with ease. Develops models (UML, OWL, SHACL), SPARQL queries and RML mappings that are considered high quality by colleagues. Writes effective model requirements. Effectively and artfully applies domain design skills in normal course of work.	Master modeler. Capable of devising new patterns and conventions within existing projects and in greenfield development. Project artifacts code remains accurate, reliable, and maintainable even when faced with challenging or complicated problems.	Acts as a subject matter expert on multiple projects. Makes strategic decisions around major components. Detects modelling red-herings and modelling smells.	Invents new concepts, creates new projects, practices, and methodologies. Pushes the whole organisation or industry forward regularly.
<i>Mastery</i>	Writes effective minute minutes and code documentation.	Grasp the domain concepts. Communicates effectively with domain experts on precise issues. Familiar with interviewing techniques and knowledge elicitation methods.	Applies interviewing and knowledge elicitation techniques with ease. Leads the domain discussions. Facilitates working group sessions effectively with a clear agenda.	Master of interviewing and knowledge elicitation. Provides alternatives to modeling domain concepts and can argue on strengths and weaknesses for each.	
<i>Scope</i>	Capable of working on tightly-scoped, routine tasks. Performs low-impact maintenance with help.	Capable of working on clearly defined and scoped individual features or problems.	Capable of taking substantial features from concept to shipping as the sole knowledge engineer (alongside a domain expert when needed).	Capable of owning and running entire project of work. Strong track record of introducing significant improvements in project quality and usability.	Can set the strategic direction for the company or the entire discipline, such modelling or LD publishing. Consistently works on projects with high complexity. Would be the go-to person for advice on the most technically challenging problems.

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<i>Judgment</i>	Demonstrates curiosity in their craft, prioritizes their own development to better serve their team. Researches what's been done in the past and why, attempts to solve problems independently.	Proactively identifies and resolves problems, improves areas of the model they work on, and leaves things in better shape than they found them. Pays attention to detail.	Has accumulated sufficient experience to be consistently sought by peers, across multiple teams, for advice. Improves existing professional standards for the team.	Has the experience, trust and respect to operate at the tech lead level. Defines professional standards. Is sought for advice across disciplines.	Is seen as a leader across teams, technically and culturally. Capable of setting and directing across an entire discipline, such as modelling, mapping or data publishing. Is known company-wide as a go-to expert for advice on critical work across disciplines.
<i>Tooling</i>	Has a rudimentary understanding of our tools.	Uses our most common tools in day to day work to help diagnose issues.	Demonstrates a comprehensive understanding of all our tools. Uses them regularly to diagnose issues quickly and calmly, even under pressure.	An expert in our tools. Extends and improves them over time. Can identify where tooling should be improved and oversee implementation.	Invents novel tools with strategic impact. Can objectively rationalise whether to build or buy, balancing tradeoffs with business strategy in mind.
Engagement					
<i>Ownership - Manager of One</i>	Participates in SE on-call rotation under guidance from more senior team member. Delivers simpler resolutions end-to-end.	Participates in SE on-call shifts with guidance from a more senior team member. Capable of handling or triaging production issues across multiple projects with minimal assistance. Can be relied upon to lead the resolution of bugs and minor improvements related to their work or area of expertise.	Can recognize and raise major incidents and lead the response from inception to resolution.	Can lead the resolution of any knowledge engineering problem in their discipline. Is a significant technical contributor to problem resolution; demonstrates consistent maturity in communication and demeanor under stress.	Fully capable of leading the most critical production incidents to successful resolution, coordinating company-wide responses and advising on public communications.
<i>Communication</i>	Proactively communicates what they are working on, attempts to unblock themselves but asks for help when needed. Questions mostly don't repeat.	Attempts to unblock themselves but ask for help when needed. Communicates well within the team structure, sharing knowledge and bringing in more experienced teammates when needed. Questions to more senior coworkers are thoroughly researched before posed.	Trusted to provide actionable feedback across team pull requests in line with our principles and methodologies. Requires little or no oversight. Provides technical advice and suggestions during planning/scoping. Drafts monthly heartbeats and Sprint planning.	Provides critical, actionable feedback on pull requests which ensures quality and consistency is upheld across the team. Demonstrates project management best practices. Ensures leadership is informed on team progress. Writes heartbeats and Sprint plannings.	Demonstrates long-term strategic thinking, working with leadership to communicate our engineering vision across teams and disciplines.

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<i>Planning</i>	Prioritizes daily work against team/project needs with regular guidance. Demonstrates good time management.	Prioritizes tasks and project work with little direction. Works confidently and effectively, persists when faced with uncertainty or ambiguity but pulls in support when needed. Contributes more broadly to Sprint planning within the team. Identifies judo opportunities on demand (find creative ways of doing things more efficiently; how to fit an elephant into a fridge).	Requires no direction to effectively manage their time, finds valuable and productive tasks to work on without prodding. Helps steer Sprint planning. Fosters collaboration across teams. Proactively spot judo opportunities in their own work and for others (find creative ways of doing things more efficiently).	Can plan an entire or multiple sprints for a team. Can drive the agenda, hammer scope, offer critical insight from extensive experience. Regularly challenges their team or discipline to help drive projects forward, to better deliver on team/discipline priorities.	Capable of running and directing larger teams for multiple cycles, and for large, long-running projects. Elevates team and company standards through developing new tooling, processes, procedures, and highly effective communication. Carries out research, testing, implementation and improvement for new systems. Pushes the whole organisation forward regularly through implementing new systems, designs and methods.
<i>Trust</i>	Work is thoroughly reviewed with substantial back and forth frequently needed before merging. Reads feedback (e.g. pull requests). Makes minor contributions to the improvement of project documentation, and simple activities.	Work is reviewed with some back and forth and the occasional need for material direction or implementation changes. Trusted to review non-critical work (e.g. pull request) to clarify style, readability, quality issues. Makes material contributions to documentation: project features, procedures, team runbooks.	Work doesn't necessarily need to be reviewed, but general approach may be. Trusted to review critical or full-batch work (pull requests), course-corrects when required. Provides context and clarity to the team by producing and maintaining documentation / runbooks (instruction manuals) / work shape pitches.	Major projects can be completed independently and shipped without review. Provides developing oversight to senior, mid, and juniors. Expected to review complex and high-impact pull requests across teams. Defines and maintains departmental standards by developing processes and procedures, writing style guides, recording internal screencasts.	Entire systems can be designed, developed, and shipped without the need for review. Provides developing oversight to everyone else in organisation. Expected to review system architecture across multiple product suites to oversee work is produced to the highest technical standards. A leader in ensuring robust and effective best practices are understood and followed across the engineering organisation.
Coachability					

<i>Feedback</i>	Observes and learns from the work and behavior of others. Receives constructive feedback with a growth mindset.	Receives constructive feedback with a growth mindset. Provides specific, well-considered feedback within area of expertise, when asked. Is able to disagree and commit (Is the feedback always really the right way to move forward?).	Can provide specific, material, constructive feedback on the work of (junior, mid, senior) SEs that deepens their knowledge across broad areas. Is able to disagree and commit (Is the feedback always really the right way to move forward?).	Acts as a formal mentor to SEs, providing specific, material, constructive feedback on work. Capable of being a technical lead on small teams. Consistently sought by colleagues for assistance with critical work or decisions. Is able to disagree and commit.	Acts as a formal mentor to SEs, providing specific, material, constructive feedback on work. Defines engineering-wide standards and guidance. Fully capable of leading teams of any size over an entire discipline. Consistently sought by colleagues across the organisation for assistance with critical work or decisions. Is able to disagree and commit.
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Benefits & Perks

Company Holidays and Public Holidays

Given that our employees come from multiple countries and diverse cultural and religious backgrounds, we cannot observe every national or religious holiday. Instead, we will announce designated company holidays in January each year. During these company holidays, the company will be closed. These holidays will primarily be selected to align with our clients' holiday schedules to minimize work interruptions.

Please note that company holidays are fixed and cannot be exchanged for other days.

Scheduling Time Off

Planning time off is a shared responsibility. Coordinate with your manager and team to ensure coverage and manage your workload. Notify your team as early as possible, especially for extended absences like vacations.

Always log your time off in the company calendar using the form available on our intranet.

Bereavement Leave

When you lose a family member, you can take paid time off from work for bereavement, making arrangements, settling family affairs, and attending the funeral or memorial service. Let your manager know your plans as soon as you can so they can arrange for your absence.

You can take 5-day bereavement leave for the death of an immediate family member (parent, spouse, and children), and 3-day leave for the death of an extended family member (grandparents). If you know you'll be away from work for much longer, please talk to your manager to discuss that special case.

Travelling for work purposes

Some Meaningfiers, as it happens, will most likely travel to one of the Meaningfy offices, conferences, fairs, clients in order to do their jobs.

If so, you should organize your travel arrangements and reservations . Meaningfy will reimburse all related expenses. Provide an expense report invoice with the plane/train/bus tickets, hotel invoices, restaurant bills at the end of the month to be refunded. See Page for detail: [Timesheet and Invoice](#)

Timesheet and Invoice

Timesheet

You are required to complete your timesheet in Jira within five days after the end of each month. Accurate and timely timesheet entries are essential for Meaningfy to run operations smoothly and invoice clients correctly.

We strongly encourage you to log your time **at least weekly**, rather than waiting until the end of the month. This keeps records up to date and helps address any issues early.

Time off / vacation

Time off (vacation) is logged in Jira **to a dedicated issue for the current year** (e.g., a specific Epic/issue created for vacations). The relevant issue will be communicated internally. When booking time off, please coordinate early with your manager and team to ensure coverage.

Company holidays

When the company is closed for designated company holidays, you should follow the same approach and log this time in Jira using the dedicated internal issue (as communicated internally).

Invoice

Invoice Submission Process

1. **Log your hours in JIRA** under every project and task you contributed to—this is the source of truth for your effort.
2. **Export your activity report** from the intranet's reporting module to verify and allocate your time accurately.
3. **Prepare and send your invoice** within seven days of month-end, attaching:
 - The exported activity report
 - Relevant receipts or documentation
 - A PDF or standard invoice file (contractors may use Zoho Invoice or their preferred invoicing tool).
4. **Submit by:**
 - Email:** send all files to accounting@meaningfy.ws
 - Email Body must contain and label the invoice number and total invoice amount in Euro so it can be automatically processed by our database system.
 - or
 - **Intranet:** upload via the dedicated invoice portal

Please note that invoices missing required documents will be rejected and will not be processed for payment.

Company Rituals: Staying Connected and Aligned

In addition to our **project rituals**—designed to report, plan, and align teams on individual projects (see "How We Work")—our **company rituals** focus on aligning everyone across Meaningfy. These rituals help us stay on the same page, share business updates, reinforce our company-wide goals, and gather valuable feedback from the team.

General Assembly (GA)

The entire company gathers in person **once a year**. Meaningfy organises the agenda, meeting space, accommodation, and social activities, and shares the details well in advance. **You only need to arrange your own travel.**

There are some scheduled talks at every GA, lightning talks, alignment sessions, peer appreciation, and team workshops. Occasionally, we bring in outside speakers or trainers.

Other than that, the GA is intentionally loosely structured. Teams huddle in a breakout room for a strategy session, groups go out for coffee or to explore the city, or managers meet 1:1 with employees.

General Assemblies usually last **a few days**. We share the dates early so you can plan ahead. Everyone is encouraged to attend, but skipping one occasionally is acceptable if you have an important commitment you can't move.

Monthly Executive Briefing

Monthly, we will present relevant company-wide information answering some of the following questions

- Reminder on Why do we do what we do?
- Where do we stand?
- Where are we headed?
- What are our values?
- What have we achieved?
- What are we proud of?
- Who do we work with?

Monthly Alignment

This is a recurring team discussion meeting with a facilitator other than CEO.

- How is the work going for you?
- What are the top three challenges?
- How can Meaningfy help?

Technical Knowledge Exchange

What it is

A monthly (or bi-monthly) slot where a volunteer colleague shares a short, content-focused talk on a technical topic (tools, techniques, lessons-learned).

Why we do it

- Surface expertise across teams
- Encourage continuous learning
- Strengthen our “one-team” culture in a fully remote setup

How it works

1. **Call for volunteers & topics:** The Operational Manager (or rotating organizer) posts in #tech-exchange asking for speakers and topic proposals.
2. **Vote on date & topic:** A simple Slack poll selects the session date and topic.
3. **Schedule & announce:** The Operational Manager adds the session to the “Technical Knowledge Exchange” Company Confluence and Google calendar.
4. **Deliver & discuss:** Presenter runs a 20–30 min demo or slide deck, then Q&A in the same Slack thread.
5. **Rotate:** Each person is encouraged to present at least once per year.

Tools & etiquette

- Use Slack threads for coordination and follow-up questions
- Keep the Confluence session calendar up to date
- Archive slides or demos in our shared drive for future reference

Ownership

- **Operational Manager:** issues Slack calls, runs polls, updates the calendar
- **Presenter:** prepares content, delivers the session, shares materials
- **Everyone:** attends, provides feedback, and proposes new topics

Final words and Acknowledgment

The employee handbook serves as a vital resource to ensure clarity, consistency, and alignment across our team. It provides the foundational guidelines, processes, and expectations that allow us to work effectively, maintain trust, and uphold Meaningfy's core values. By understanding and adhering to the policies outlined in this handbook, you contribute to fostering a collaborative, respectful, and high-performing work environment.

This handbook is not just a document; it is a shared agreement that helps us align as a team, operate efficiently, and achieve our goals. Whether you're seeking information about company tools, processes, or expectations, the handbook is your go-to reference for clarity and support.

Acknowledgment

Andrian Savciuc
I, _____, hereby acknowledge that I have received the Meaningfy Employee Handbook. I confirm that I have read and understood the contents of the handbook, including the guidelines, policies, and expectations outlined within.

Date:	1/30/2026	Signature:	
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We're excited to have you on this journey with us and look forward to the great things we'll accomplish together!